

CITY: PG 3

CM gives jobs boost to MCD employees



NATION: PG 5

Dialogue, dignity, inclusion essential for effective access to justice: CJI



FILM: PG 12

A story of people behind the uniforms



Gen Z to shape ‘Viksit Bharat’: PM

AT IIT-DELHI CONVOCATION, MODI SAYS EVERY GENERATION HAS A NATIONAL RESPONSIBILITY

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday told students at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi, that the decisions they make over the next three to four decades will influence India's journey towards becoming a ‘Viksit Bharat’.

Addressing the 57th convocation ceremony of IIT Delhi, Modi said every generation faces its own challenges and carries a specific national responsibility. He asked the students to consider how their decisions could contribute to the country and address its needs, news agency PTI reported.

“You are all aware that every generation faces the specific challenges of its time and also bears its own national responsibility. Whatever you do over the next 30 to 35 years of your lives will influence our journey towards a ‘Viksit Bharat’.

Therefore, the basis of every decision you make should also



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the 57th Convocation Ceremony of Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), in New Delhi. Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi, IIT Delhi Board of Governors (BoG) Chairperson Adv. Harish Salve and others are also present

be: how will this benefit the country? Which of the nation's needs will this fulfil?” he said.

Modi said the world and technology are changing rapidly and whoever learns will win, as he asked students to keep their curiosity alive.

He said challenges become chances for those with courage to find new solutions.

“Today, the world is changing

YOUTH POWER

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ing rapidly. Nobody can say what will happen 20-30 years from now. Keep your curiosity alive in life... Keep your learning instinct alive. Those who learn, win,” he said.

Modi said people who are open to new situations and challenges will turn challenges into chances and “this is what you have learned at IIT Delhi”.

Modi said India is now working towards becoming

Russian oil buyers face US Senate heat

India, China among buyers in focus

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

WASHINGTON: The US Senate voted overwhelmingly to approve a Bill to punish Russia and key buyers of its petroleum products, such as China and India, claiming that such trade helps fuel the Ukraine war.

The bill, renamed the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, was approved by the Senate by an 86-11 vote.

It allows President Donald Trump to impose 100 per cent tariffs on goods from countries that are top five importers of Russian oil and gas. At present China, India, Azerbaijan, Hungary and Slovakia are the top five importers of oil and gas from Russia.

In addition to Russia sanctions, the Bill would extend till 2031 the expiration date of the Iran Sanctions Act of 1996, which penalises companies that invest in Iran's energy sector.

The bipartisan bill was championed by Republican senator Lindsey Graham, who passed away on July 11, and Democrat Richard Blumenthal. After Graham's sudden death following a trip to Kyiv, leaders across the aisle moved with renewed vigour to ensure passage of the bill and honour the late Senator's legacy as an ally of Ukraine.

It also seeks to impose sanctions on Russian leaders and officials, targeting Russian President Vladimir Putin, oligarchs and financial institutions.

Following the vote, Senator Blumenthal told reporters that Graham would be “proud of what we've done. These sledgehammer sanctions and tariffs will stop all who are complicit in this murderous, criminal war of aggression against brave free people.”

Some Democrats have warned that the bill would give Trump new tariff powers at a time when he has put



OIL PRESSURE

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such levies at the centre of his trade policy.

The bill will now go to the House of Representatives for approval when it reconvenes on August 31.

Democrat Congressmen Gregory Meeks and Don Beyer have criticised the legislation for creating “sweeping new tariff authorities that the president could weaponise with abandon, as he has repeatedly done in the past”.

The US Senate's approval of a bill on Russia sanctions could expose Indian exports to additional tariffs of up to 100 per cent if India continues buying Russian crude oil, think tank GTRI said on Saturday.

The Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) said that India, being the second-largest buyer of Russian crude, is exposed to high tariffs.

US V-P, PM Modi hold phone call

Discuss strategic partnership

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: US Vice President JD Vance on Friday dialled Prime Minister Narendra Modi and discussed ways to expand India-US comprehensive global strategic partnership across key areas.

Modi congratulated Vance and Second Lady Usha on the birth of their son.

Vance's call to the prime minister came days after Türkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan signed a mutual defence pact that was widely seen as a signal of a new regional alignment amid the West Asia conflict.

“Received a phone call from US Vice President JD Vance. We discussed ways to further deepen India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership across key areas,” Modi said on social media.

“Warmly congratulated him and the Second Lady on the birth of their son and conveyed best wishes to the entire family,” he said.

The American side has not yet provided any details of the conversation.

PAPER LEAK ROW

J'khand: Talks fail



MPOST BUREAU

RANCHI: The Jharkhand government on Saturday held talks with various outfits amid the massive agitation over the alleged paper leaks in recruitment exams, but failed to break the deadlock as the protesting aspirants decided that their stir would continue until all their demands are met.

A five-member panel of the government, which included state ministers, first met the faction of protesters led by JLKM leader Devendra Nath Mahto, whose fast over the issue entered its seventh day.

They then separately met delegations of the Congress-backed NSUI, ACS and JCM.

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Continued on P4

TAKEAWAYS

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DMK, AIADMK BOYCOTT MEETING

TN MPs close ranks against delimitation

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay-led meeting of Tamil Nadu MPs belonging to alliance and friendly parties on Saturday decided to oppose in total the proposed delimitation exercise of the union government.

The meeting was boycotted by the main Opposition party, the DMK, and key Dravidian party, the AIADMK, which dubbed the deliberations a “farce” and a “hurriedly staged drama” respectively.

A government release said the MPs demanded that the ratio of seats between Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha must remain at 2.2:1 and it was unanimously decided to adopt a resolution in the State Assembly to permanently safeguard the rights of Tamil Nadu and the other south Indian states in this matter.

The release added that the CM appealed, at the end of the meeting, to all MPs and parties, to work in tandem to uphold the rights of Tamil Nadu. He appealed that the proposed delimitation exercise must be dropped by the Centre since it will affect the representation and importance of Tamil Nadu.

Briefing reporters after the meeting, Law Minister R Nirmal Kumar said that it had been decided at the meeting to oppose the proposed exercise as no change is needed as regards the composition of law makers in elected bodies.

“No change is needed in the number of 543 (in Lok Sabha). Similarly, no change is warranted as regards the 39 LS seats in Tamil Nadu,” he said, quoting the decision taken at the CM-led gathering.

The law minister alleged that the



Congress, BJP spar over Bills

NEW DELHI: The Congress and BJP sparred on Saturday over the women's quota and delimitation Bills after Rahul Gandhi said that no country can be successful if its women do not express themselves, prompting Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju to call it a “visible change of heart” and express the hope that the opposition party will support the proposed legislation. See P4

delimitation initiative was being pursued by the BJP government at the Centre eyeing easy election win and for the sake of “election arithmetic.” Hence, he said that Tamil Nadu does not need delimitation.

“Why do you want to do delimitation? Who is going to be benefited? Kumar asked and demanded that the proposed exercise be dropped and “delimitation freeze” be extended further by another 25 years. Parliamentarians belonging to the ruling TVK's alliance parties, the Congress, VCK, MDMK and IUML took part in the brainstorming. Continued on P4

CONSUMERS SAFE, SELECT MERCHANTS MAY PAY

UPI stays free, but MDR knocks later

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The government on Saturday categorically stated that consumers and small merchants will continue to enjoy free Unified Payments Interface (UPI) services to allay fears regarding the levy of charges on such transactions following the passage of a Bill to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007.

However, nominal Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) for merchants will be applicable as and when charges are introduced.

“They will apply only to a limited set of merchant transactions, above a certain threshold, at a nominal rate, far lower than debit or credit card



UPI UPDATE

- » Nominal Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) for merchants will be applicable as and when charges are introduced
- » They will apply only to a limited set of merchant transactions, above a certain threshold, at a nominal rate, far lower than debit or credit card MDRs

MDRs,” Union Finance Ministry said in a statement.

The statement comes two days after the Lok Sabha passed a Bill to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, which authorises the government to permit banks and other service providers to levy charges on payments through

will decide on the MDR, if any,” it said.

The recent amendment to the Payment and Settlement Systems Act (PSS Act) has generated a debate, with some misinterpreting it as a move to impose charges on ordinary users, it said, adding, in reality, the amendment is an enabling provision designed to ensure UPI's long-term sustainability, technological advancement, and resilience against emerging risks.

Explaining the rationale, the statement said, with exponential transaction volumes, the system requires significant and continuous upgrades in cybersecurity, fraud prevention, and infrastructure.

Continued on P4

ROARING BOND

Pair of lions seen interacting in their enclosure at the Nehru Zoological Park, in Hyderabad, on Saturday PTI

RAIN FURY: Himachal, Kerala reel from havoc



Assam toll 98; Delhi records wettest August

NEW DELHI: Rain fury eased in several parts of the country on Saturday; however, destruction prevailed in its wake, with the death toll in Assam mounting to 98, mobility paralysed with 153 roads blocked in Himachal Pradesh and hundreds in Kerala staying put in relief camps

due to damage to houses and roads. Marking a four-day streak of show-ers, the national capital on Saturday recorded its wettest August day in two years, with the month's rainfall total nearly reaching the monthly average in just the first eight days.

See P4

Shah urges UCBs to look at RBI from a ‘different viewpoint’

The Union Minister of Cooperation said that when it comes to safety of money, no other segment is as safe for lenders as small borrowers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Union Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah on Saturday urged urban cooperative banks (UCBs) to look at the RBI from a “different viewpoint”, underlining that the central bank has “proactively helped” the sector in recent times.

Speaking at the inauguration of a new office building of the National Urban Cooperative Finance and Development Corporation (NUCFDC) at the BSE here, Shah also said that when it comes to the safety of money, no other segment is as safe for lenders as small borrowers.

“I know of your experience till now, RBI looks at you from a particular viewpoint, and UCBs also look at RBI from a different viewpoint. But we have to come out of it,” Shah told the audience comprising executives from over 1,400 UCBs and other stakeholders.

“My five years’ experience as the Union Cooperatives Minister suggests that whenever we have put a step forward with confidence, RBI has pro-



Union Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah

actively helped us,” he added, listing out the relaxations delivered by RBI.

Among other aspects, RBI has liberalised branch opening, allowed UCBs to offer doorstep banking, made it possible for them to issue demand drafts and life certificates, and also appointed a dedicated nodal officer just to look into the affairs of the UCBs, which have over Rs 6 lakh crore of deposits, he said.

Shah said a lot of aspects have been resolved with the help of the RBI, and also welcomed the raising of limits on gold loans and permitting one-time settlements for UCBs.

In a statement on developmental and regulatory policy accompanying the bi-monthly

HIGHLIGHTS

» ‘RBI has liberalised branch opening, allowed UCBs to offer doorstep banking, made it possible for them to issue demand drafts and life certificates’

» The minister urged urban cooperative banks to embrace technology, ensure transparency and modernise customer services to remain competitive

policy review announced on Wednesday, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra announced a move forward on the ‘on-tap’ licensing of UCBs, which will end a two-decades long pause in the matter.

In the past, instances of lax governance practices at UCBs, which are perceived to be controlled by political heavyweights, have led to instances of some lenders going down, leading to higher systemic caution.

Recalling his experience of chairing a UCB in Gujarat, Shah said the small borrower segment is the safest for lenders and pointed out a scheme of offering Rs 2.5 lakh of loans without any collateral by his bank. He said the management had doubts, but the repayment

rate including interest is over 99 per cent under the scheme, and the overall lending offered has been doubled as well.

Shah also announced that NUCFDC, which works as an umbrella body for the sector, will soon be moving its head office to Maharashtra from New Delhi, and added that 449 of such lenders are in the state and 70 per cent of the entities are from Maharashtra, Gujarat, Goa and Karnataka.

He said the body has only 690 members as of now, and urged the management to lower membership fees and ensure that all 1,400 UCBs avail the membership.

A lot of advantages will accrue to a lender by joining a grouping like NUCFDC, Shah

said, adding that the umbrella organisation can give technical know-how, help with compliances, and offer the best in cyber security solutions.

He said a security operations centre has also been opened as part of the efforts, and urged the UCBs to join that as well to deepen the depositors’ faith.

On the issue of scaling up, Shah pointed to the Amul experience of how a string of cooperatives can come together to create a brand with a Rs 1.25 lakh crore turnover now, and added that if India has to become a developed nation as aspired, UCBs will play an important role by supporting the sole proprietors or entrepreneurs in the economy.

Further, the minister urged urban cooperative banks to embrace technology, ensure transparency and modernise customer services to remain competitive.

He also urged all urban cooperative banks to join the NUCFDC, the apex umbrella organisation for the sector, within a year.

NBFC gold loans grow nearly 70% to ₹3.41 lakh crore in June: RBI

Retail loans grew 20.3% year-on-year in June 2026, accelerating from 14.3% growth recorded a year earlier

NEW DELHI: Gold-backed lending by non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) continued to grow at nearly 70 per cent year-on-year in June 2026, extending the sharp expansion seen in the previous month, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

Outstanding NBFC loans against gold jewellery rose 69.3 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3.41 lakh crore at the end of June 2026, after recording 69.9 per cent growth in May.

The latest numbers indicate that the strong growth in gold-backed lending has continued into June, with loans against gold jewellery growing significantly faster than the overall retail loan portfolio of NBFCs.

Retail loans grew 20.3 per cent year-on-year in June 2026, accelerating from 14.3 per cent growth recorded a year earlier.

“Within retail loans, ‘housing,’ ‘vehicle’ and ‘loans against gold jewellery’ segments displayed robust credit growth,” the RBI said in its sectoral deployment of credit release.

According to the accompanying RBI data, outstanding retail loans increased to around Rs 25.62 lakh crore in June 2026 from Rs 21.29 lakh crore a year earlier. Within retail lending, housing loans grew 11.4 per



cent year-on-year to around Rs 8.44 lakh crore, while vehicle loans increased 15.2 per cent to around Rs 6.24 lakh crore. Consumer durable loans recorded a sharper 46.8 per cent rise to Rs 72,201 crore.

The continued expansion in gold-backed lending comes as the RBI has strengthened the regulatory framework governing loans against gold and silver collateral. The central bank had issued the Reserve Bank of India (Lending Against Gold and Silver Collateral) Directions, 2025 in June last year, laying down a harmonised regulatory framework for such loans across regulated entities, including NBFCs.

The directions followed supervisory concerns flagged by the central bank in September 2024. RBI had identified deficiencies in gold-loan practices, including shortcomings in the use of third parties for sourcing and appraisal of loans, inadequate due diligence, weaknesses

in monitoring loan-to-value ratios and lack of transparency during auctions of gold jewellery in cases of default. RBI had also asked regulated entities to closely monitor their gold-loan portfolios in view of significant growth seen at some lenders.

However, the growth was uneven across sectors. Credit to industry grew 6.7 per cent year-on-year, slowing from 10.3 per cent in June 2025.

The RBI said the moderation was “primarily driven by subdued growth in infrastructure, a major constituent of the segment.”

Services sector credit growth also moderated to 17.6 per cent from 22.4 per cent a year earlier. Commercial real estate recorded strong expansion, while growth in credit to trade and transport operators moderated.

Agriculture and allied activities, on the other hand, recorded credit growth of 17.9 per cent in June, sharply higher than 5.1 per cent a year earlier.

The RBI said the provisional sectoral credit data are based on a sample of NBFCs in the Upper and Middle Layers and housing finance companies, which together account for about 87 per cent of total credit covered by the central bank’s reference data.

ANI

Unclaimed MF dividends rise 15.7% in FY26: SEBI

NEW DELHI: Unclaimed dividend amounts lying with mutual funds increased by 15.7 per cent to Rs 2,689 crore at the end of FY26, even as unclaimed redemption proceeds declined marginally during the year, according to the SEBI Annual Report 2025-26.

The amount of unclaimed mutual fund dividends rose by

Rs 365 crore from Rs 2,324 crore at the end of 2024-25, the report showed. In contrast, unclaimed redemption amounts declined 0.5 per cent to Rs 1,122 crore from Rs 1,128 crore a year earlier.

“Meanwhile, the unclaimed dividend amount registered an increase of 15.7 per cent reaching ₹2,689 crore in 2025-26

from Rs 2,324 crore in 2024-25,” SEBI said in the report.

Taken together, unclaimed dividend and redemption amounts in mutual funds stood at Rs 3,811 crore as of March 31, 2026, compared with Rs 3,452 crore at the end of the preceding financial year, according to figures in the report. The rise comes as SEBI has stepped up

measures aimed at reducing the volume of financial assets that remain unclaimed and making it easier for investors & their nominees to access their holdings. In its annual report, SEBI said it has enabled integration of holdings with DigiLocker, allowing investors to access demat & mutual fund information at a single location. ANI

Vande Bharatam selects 1st cohort from 26K+ entries

AHMEDABAD: Vande Bharatam, the grassroots innovation and entrepreneurship initiative launched by Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani, has selected its inaugural cohort from more than 26,000 applications across India.

Vande Bharatam received applications with ideas spanning mobility, sustainability, technology, agriculture, defence,

healthcare, manufacturing, education and other sectors.

The cohort brings together innovators from varied regions, disciplines and backgrounds, united by the ambition to solve the nation’s problems, build nation-building enterprises and create nationwide impact.

Vande Bharatam aims to connect promising innovators with top mentors, industry lead-

ers, visibility and opportunities, to turn ideas into meaningful enterprises. The initiative is built on Adani’s deeply held belief in giving back to the country that gave him the opportunity to dream, build and grow, and in creating pathways for others to do the same.

Speaking on the launch of the first cohort, Gautam Adani said: “When I look at these

innovators, I see the possibilities of tomorrow’s Bharat. Talent has no city limits & opportunity should not have them either. Years from now, I hope we will look back at this first cohort & see among them the founders & innovators who went on to build enterprises that transformed Bharat. This is their initial chapter. And it is Vande Bharatam’s first chapter too.”

MP0ST

Sport

Making No. 3 count

Padikkal seals No. 3 spot with stylish hundred as Jaiswal, Pant fail to impress

COLOMBO: Devdutt Padikkal assured his spot in India’s playing eleven for the opening Test with a stylish century on the second day of the warm-up match against Sri Lanka Cricket XI, while seasoned Rishabh Pant and his understudy Dhruv Jurel failed to make the most of favourable batting conditions.

At the end of the second day, India finished its first innings at 357 for eight in 90 overs. Padikkal’s artistic unbeaten 142 and a gritty 63 (retired out) by veteran Ravindra Jadeja were the highlights, while Manav Suthar (41) also impressed with the bat on his maiden overseas international assignment.

The pitch had become much easier to bat on, and Padikkal took full advantage, hitting 18 delectable boundaries to show that he is ready to reclaim his rightful place now that first-choice No. 3 batter Sai Sudharsan has been ruled out of the series after failing to recover in time from his big-toe injury.

With Yashasvi Jaiswal (0) falling off the second delivery of the day while attempting to flash at left-arm seamer Vishwa Fernando (1/42), KL Rahul (40) and Padikkal added 96 for the second wicket.

While Rahul played him-



Devidutt Padikkal retired after getting to his century

BCCI

self in, the sinewy Padikkal was a treat to watch, opening with a couple of cover drives off fuller deliveries before unleashing some delectable cuts both in front of and behind point. He was particularly severe on right arm pacer Ishitha Wijesundara who was hit for multiple boundaries. Anything short from pacers or spinners was pulled with a lot of disdain. The famous ‘Nataraja Shot’ also came out of the closet against

the pacers.

The hallmark of Padikkal’s batting was the extra second he almost seems to have while deciding on his execution. His defence has also got tighter and the footwork against spinners has been exemplary. A pull shot off off-spinner Ramesh Mendis brought up his ton in just 121 balls before he was asked to retire.

By then, he had added 72 runs for the third wicket with

Jadeja, who again showed why he is a valuable asset as a middle order batter overseas even as his spin bowling stocks has depleted quite considerably.

The biggest disappointment of the day was certainly Rishabh Pant (2) who once again played an indiscreet shot against off-spinner Mendis (2/77) trying to hit him against the turn over long-on. The leading edge flew to long-off.

AGENCIES

Sudharsan ruled out of series

NEW DELHI: Talented top order batter B Sai Sudharsan was on Saturday ruled out of the two-Test series against Sri Lanka after failing to recover from a big toe injury sustained during the India A tour of the island nation last month.

Sudharsan, who scored two tons in two ‘A’ Test matches, was hit during the second game against Sri Lanka ‘A’ and since then has been in rehabilitation at the Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru.

“Sai Sudharsan has been ruled out of the upcoming Test series against Sri Lanka. Doctors have advised more time for biological healing. Significant improvement, but not yet sufficient for a safe return to Test cricket,” according to the update from the Sports Science team which is monitoring the rehabilitation of the player. AGENCIES

HER MAIDEN BWF WORLD TOUR FINAL

On a giant-killing run, Chaliha reaches final at Korea Masters

ASAN: Ashmita Chaliha continued her impressive run at the Korea Masters Super 300, overcoming teenage compatriot Rakshitha Ramraj 21-13 16-21 21-13 to reach her maiden BWF World Tour singles final, here on Saturday.

The 26-year-old Indian, who returned to competition in May after a three-month layoff due to a medial meniscus tear in her right knee, has enjoyed a strong comeback on the BWF Tour, including a semifinal appearance at the Macau Open.

World Ranked 50 Ashmita, who trains under Park Tae-sang at the National center of excellence, Guwahati, will now battle China’s Han Qianxi for the title in the summit clash.

The World Ranked 35 Qian

Xi, seeded fourth, battled past 22-20, 18-21, 21-14 in a one-hour five-minute battle in the other semifinal.

Ashmita’s run also marks

back-to-back BWF World Tour

finals for Indians, with Tanvi

Sharma having won the Taipei

Open last Sunday.

Indian shuttlers have now made finals across several events this season, with Ayush Shetty at the Asia Championships, Lakshya Sen at the All England, Devika Sihag at the



Ashmita Chaliha overcame Rakshitha Ramraj 21-13, 16-21, 21-13 BWF

She will now battle China’s Han Qianxi for the title in the summit clash

Thailand Masters, Kidambi Srikanth at the US Open, Tanvi at the Taipei Open, PV Sindhu at the Japan Open, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty at the Singapore Open, and now Ashmita at the Korea Masters.

Ashmita, who had stunned top seed and world No. 22 Hina Akechi of Japan in the quarterfinals, came out aggressively and quickly moved from 2-2 to 6-2 in the opening game.

She then reeled off five straight points to establish a 13-6 lead before closing the

game out 21-13.

Rakshitha, who had upset third seed and compatriot Tanvi Sharma in the quarterfinals after coming from a game down, responded strongly.

The 19-year-old Pullela Gopichand Academy trainee raced to a 4-1 lead. Ashmita struggled to control the lifts and went long twice, besides finding the net, to fall 3-8 behind.

Another lift going long gave Rakshitha a five-point advantage. A brutal smash at 6-12 down from the left-handed Ashmita was the first convincing shot from the Indian in the second game. Another straight smash, a return of serve going into the net and a long lift from Rakshitha meant Ashmita narrowed the gap to 12-13. AGENCIES

WORLD U20 CHAMPIONSHIPS

Ashish follows Neeraj’s footsteps with silver Medal

EUGENE: Ashish Yadav won a silver in the men’s javelin throw event to open India’s medal account, while national senior record holder Pooja Singh qualified for the women’s high jump final at the World Athletics U20 Championships here.

Yadav’s third-round throw of 74.09m fetched him the sil-



ver medal while T Dharanidharan, the other Indian in the fray in the men’s javelin throw finals on Friday, finished sixth with 72.35m.

Yadav’s effort was 40cm short of his personal best of 74.49m, which he had recorded during the Indian Open Throws Competition in Pati-

ala in March.

The 19-year-old Yadav became the second Indian, after two-time Olympic medallist Neeraj Chopra, to win a silver in the event.

Chopra had won gold and set the still-standing world junior record of 86.48m in the 2016 edition in Poland. AGENCIES

‘Win at all costs’: 1975 hockey heroes urge India

NEW DELHI: India’s 1975 World Cup heroes Ashok Kumar and Aslam Sher Khan have urged the national hockey team to put the country ahead of individual ambitions, saying an uncompromising desire to win for the nation can help end the 51-year wait for a World Cup medal. India has won the men’s World Cup only once, in Kuala Lumpur in 1975 when

they defeated Pakistan 2-1 in the final. Ashok scored the winning goal in the 51st minute to script one of the most memorable moments in Indian hockey history. His message to the current side is simple.

“I would say to the Indian team: keep in mind that victory or defeat will not be yours, but your country’s. This will automatically inspire you.

This 51-year wait has been too long, and now we have to win a medal,” Ashok said.

The World Cup is scheduled to be held in the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30.

Aslam, who scored the important equaliser in the semi-final against Malaysia, believes the current players need to approach the World

Cup with the same sense of patriotism that drove the 1975 team.

“When we entered the World Cup, our country was like our mother, and we played with that same passion. You too must enter the field with the thought that we are playing for our mother, and our passion must be such that we will win at all costs,” he said. AGENCIES

CM gives jobs boost to 187 MCD employees

Move aimed at strengthening civic body workforce

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Saturday issued appointment letters to 187 newly appointed candidates, including 17 special educators, in a move aimed at strengthening its human resource base and improving civic services.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who attended the appointment letter distribution ceremony at the Kedarnath Sahni Auditorium at the Civic Centre as the chief guest, said filling long-pending vacancies was an important step towards making the civic body more effective.

Gupta said the MCD was directly linked to the day-to-day civic needs of Delhi's residents and that adequate manpower was essential for delivering timely and efficient services. "The foremost objective of the responsibility you are about to undertake should be public service," she said, urging the newly appointed candidates to perform their duties with integrity, sensitivity and commitment.

The Chief Minister said the government was focusing on strengthening the Corporation through modern technology, infrastructure, human resources and financial support. She also highlighted ongoing efforts to expand MCD hospitals through new buildings and additional blocks and improve their medical facilities.

During the event, Gupta also launched a Medical Screening Portal aimed at facilitating medical examinations and regular health monitoring of children studying in MCD-run schools. The initiative is intended to make health mon-

Kanwar Yatra passed smoothly: CM

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta visited a Kanwar camp near the Delhi-Uttar Pradesh border in East Delhi's Dilshad Garden area on Saturday, saying the government ensured that participants in the Kanwar Yatra do not face any difficulties.

"Whether it is financial assistance, sanitation arrangements, or power and water supply, the Delhi government ensured that Kanwar camps were well maintained. Like last year, this year also, every effort has been made to ensure that our devotees of Bhole do not face even the slightest problem," Gupta said while addressing a gathering. The Delhi government had earlier approved a proposal to increase the financial assistance provided to Kanwar committees for Kanwar Yatra 2026.

Under the cabinet's decision, large Kanwar camps spread over more than 20,000 square feet and operating for six to twelve days will now be eligible for financial assistance of up to Rs 15 lakh. This year, the Kanwar Yatra commenced on July 30 with the start of the holy month of Shrawan and will conclude on August 11.



CM Rekha Gupta during the event

MPOST

Lakshmi Yojana gets 5.14 lakh registrations in a week: CM

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Lakshmi Yojana has received over 5.14 lakh registrations within seven days of its launch, with more than 2.18 lakh applications finally submitted so far, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday. The scheme, launched on August 1, provides financial assistance of Rs 2,500 per month to eligible women, according to the Delhi government.

Gupta described the response to the scheme as unprecedented, saying the number of registrations reflected the women's trust in the initiative to provide financial support and promote savings. As of Saturday afternoon, 5,14,460 women had registered under the scheme, while 2,18,728 applications had been finally submitted, according to data shared by the chief minister's office.

MPOST

iting more systematic and technology-driven.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi, who was the guest of honour, said the appointment letters would bring "new hope, stability and confidence" to 187 families that had been waiting for employment opportunities.

He said 31 of the 49 appointments made in one category had gone to women, describing it as a step towards women's empowerment. The Mayor

added that the process for another 268 appointments was underway, while requisitions for 168 posts had been sent to the Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board (DSSSB). The MCD also issued appointment letters to 92 Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) candidates on compassionate grounds. Wahi said the appointments were intended to provide support and a dignified livelihood to families facing difficult circumstances.

L-G seeks traders' take on market woes

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has sought feedback from representatives of major markets on issues including unauthorised encroachments, traffic congestion and parking management, while stressing the need to keep commercial hubs accessible and orderly. Sandhu interacted with representatives of market and traders' associations from several prominent markets, including Sarojini Nagar, Lajpat Nagar, Connaught Place, Mori Gate and Chandni Chowk, where issues affecting traders, shoppers and daily business were discussed.

During the meeting, the lieutenant governor also sought first-hand feedback on the effectiveness of 'Jan Sunwai' being conducted by the Delhi Police at police stations across the city.

He said direct interaction with traders and residents was important to assess whether public grievances relating to safety, traffic, encroachments and other local issues were being



addressed promptly.

The representatives raised concerns regarding encroachments, traffic snarls and parking arrangements in busy commercial areas, according to a statement issued by the lieutenant governor's office. Sandhu emphasised the need for strict enforcement against violations while also calling for better urban planning and civic arrangements to address recurring problems in the markets. He said that Delhi's major commercial hubs play an important role in the city's economy and stressed that their accessibility, cleanliness, pedestrian spaces and overall appeal should be maintained. The lieutenant governor also underlined the importance of walkability, smooth traffic movement.

AGENCIES

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: For many Delhi residents, Friday's rain was less a weather event than a reminder of a problem that returns with every monsoon — roads disappearing under stagnant water, overflowing garbage, damaged streets and a civic system struggling to keep pace.

By Saturday, the rain had not entirely loosened its grip on the capital, with several parts of Delhi-NCR continuing to report waterlogging and disruption to daily life.

The national capital received moderate to heavy rainfall on Friday, August 7, resulting in extensive waterlogging across several areas. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast more rain over the weekend, with light to very light rainfall likely to continue till August 13.

In Shaheen Bagh, particularly around 40 Futa Road, stretches of the road were

Teen swept away in drain amid heavy rain

NEW DELHI: An 18-year-old man went missing after being swept away by rainwater in a drain while crossing it amid heavy downpour in southeast Delhi's Priyanka Camp area, triggering a large-scale search operation by rescue teams, police said. The incident took place on Friday evening near the Priyanka Camp Nala in Madanpur Khadar within the Sarita Vihar police station limits, and the missing person has been identified as Ankit, a resident of Bhim Colony.

A PCR call was received at the Sarita Vihar police station on Friday evening informing that a youth got swept away in a drain, following which a team was sent to the spot.

AGENCIES

AIIMS acts against guard over misconduct

NEW DELHI: The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, has terminated a security guard following a complaint of inappropriate behaviour towards a woman attendant, after a video of the alleged incident circulated on social media.

A reel posted on Instagram purportedly showed a security guard attempting to touch the woman inappropriately.

The video subsequently drew attention online, prompting concerns over the safety and dignity of women at the premier medical institution.

In a press release issued on Saturday, AIIMS New Delhi said it had taken "strict action" against security guard Dhananjay Singh following a complaint regarding inappropriate behaviour with a woman patient attendant. According to the institute, the guard has been terminated from service, while a penalty has also been imposed on the security agency employing him. AIIMS said a police complaint was lodged for further action.

MPOST

WETTEST AUGUST DAY IN TWO YEARS

Rain returns, so do Delhi's civic woes



submerged, leaving vehicles stranded and some falling into open ditches. Garbage dumped along the roadside was washed into the streets, making it difficult to distinguish the road from the accumulated water.

"For us, even reaching school safely has become a struggle," said Hamza, a Class X student from the area. "We are fighting for basic things such as clean roads. We have been on leave because of the rain, but how long are we expected to live like this in the capital?"

For local traders, the waterlogging has translated into lost

business. A restaurant owner in Shaheen Bagh said customers had stopped visiting despite shops remaining open.

"The market is known for its food, but who will come when the roads are under water?" he said, adding that poor drainage, damaged roads and inadequate infrastructure had made the monsoon particularly difficult for businesses.

The crisis was equally visible in Zakir Nagar, where the MCD Pratibha Vidyalaya was reported to be waterlogged. Parents said children had to be carried through the water,

while students described the situation as something they had witnessed repeatedly during previous monsoons. "If the civic body cannot protect its own schools from waterlogging, how will it protect Delhi?" a parent asked.

In Gaffar Manzil, residents said a major connecting road towards Haji Colony and lanes 13, 14 and 15 had remained damaged for four days.

Despite complaints, residents alleged that repair work had not begun before the rain worsened the situation.

Further south, Sangam Vihar's A-163 ward resembled a large pool on Friday. Schoolchildren struggled through the water, vehicles stalled as water reached their engines and roadside shops were surrounded by stagnant water.

Residents voiced a familiar frustration: every monsoon brings the same disruption, while complaints often yield little more than temporary attention.

Delhi Police felicitates 16 innovators for AI-based policing solutions

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police on Saturday felicitated 16 young innovators for developing citizen-centric technology solutions as part of its Summer Internship Programme-2026 at Police Headquarters.

Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar felicitated the interns at a ceremony held at Police Headquarters, recognising their contribution to developing technology-driven solutions for modern policing.

Launched to foster collaboration between Delhi Police and premier academic institutions, the internship programme commenced on June 8 and received more than 400 applications from students across leading universities and technical institutions.

Following a rigorous selec-



tion process, 16 students from IIT Delhi, Delhi Technological University (DTU), Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University (GGSIPU), Jamia Hamdard, Guru Tegh Bahadur Institute of Technology (GTBIT) and other institutions were selected for the programme. Working under the mentorship of officers from the Tech & Project Implementation Division of Delhi Police, the interns developed four functional solutions aimed at

improving administrative efficiency, streamlining internal processes, strengthening citizen services and supporting the force's digital transformation through AI-based solutions.

Addressing the interns, Kumar congratulated them on their dedication, innovation and technical excellence, and stressed the importance of academia-police collaboration in developing technology-driven solutions for modern policing.

MPOST



DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA



YOUR VIGILANCE, OUR SAFETY

FREEDOM IS OUR CELEBRATION.
VIGILANCE IS EVERYONE'S DUTY.

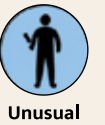
EVERY ALERT CITIZEN STRENGTHENS DELHI'S SECURITY.

If you notice an unattended object, unusual behaviour, suspicious activity or an unfamiliar vehicle parked for an unusually long time, do not ignore it.

Keep a safe distance and inform Delhi Police immediately.



Unattended Object



Unusual Behaviour



Unfamiliar Vehicle



Suspicious Activity



One alert call can protect many lives



EMERGENCY 112



EYES & EARS HELPLINE 14547

Make sure to verify buyers and sellers of vehicles

Always verify your tenants, workers and guests in the hotels / home stays

If you notice something suspicious, report to Police immediately

Stay extra alert in crowded public places

Always co-operate during security checks and follow police instructions

Share only verified information. Do not spread rumours



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DP 9898/2026

Govt's drone policy likely to get nod soon; over 1K jobs on cards

NEW DELHI: IT minister Pankaj Singh said on Saturday that the Delhi government's proposed drone policy aims to create over 1,000 jobs in the city.

The policy, currently under development, will emphasise establishing drone

research clusters, dedicated flight testing facilities, utilising drones for traffic management, and providing subsidies to enhance the drone ecosystem.

"A comprehensive drone policy is being planned to ensure safe and regulated drone

operations, along with job opportunities. The policy is ready; we plan to table it for cabinet approval in a month," Singh said.

The policy is being developed by the government's information and technology (IT) department.

AGENCIES

AIMED AT STREAMLINING UPKEEP OF ROADS IN HIGH-SECURITY ZONE NDMC to take over Central Vista road upkeep

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) will now take over the maintenance of major roads in the Central Vista area, including Janpath, Rafi Marg and Man Singh Road, from the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), according to officials.

An order issued by the Union Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry on August 7 said the NDMC would be responsible for the upkeep,

Highlights

» The move changes an arrangement that had been in place since March 2007, when the maintenance of roads in the Central Vista area was transferred from the NDMC to the CPWD

» The move marks a shift towards a more localised system of civic management in Lutyens' Delhi

resurfacing, cleaning and other municipal works on the roads, while Kartavya Path would con-

tinue to be maintained by the CPWD. The move changes an arrangement that had been in

place since March 2007, when the maintenance of roads in the Central Vista area was transferred from the NDMC to the CPWD through a 2006 ministry order, officials said.

According to officials, the move marks a shift towards a more localised system of civic management in Lutyens' Delhi, with the council taking over the upkeep of roads in the Central Vista area from the CPWD, except Kartavya Path.

AGENCIES

ASSAM FLOOD TOLL MOUNTS TO 98

Rain fury: HP, Kerala reel from havoc

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Rain fury eased in several parts of the country on Saturday; however, destruction prevailed in its wake, with the death toll in Assam mounting to 98, mobility paralysed with 153 roads blocked in Himachal Pradesh and hundreds in Kerala staying put in relief camps due to damage to houses and roads.

In Assam, more than 1.55 lakh people remained affected by floods, with the toll in this year's deluge reaching 98 with one more fatality, officials said on Saturday.

Even as 13 districts remained affected, the government will, from Sunday, launch an assessment of damage caused by the deluge to expedite release of funds for permanent rehabilitation in the four worst-hit districts in the eastern part of the state.

In Himachal Pradesh, torrential rains have led to the closure of 153 roads, and the Shimla MeT Office issued an 'orange alert' for heavy to very



Local residents inspect a tree uprooted following heavy downpours and strong storm winds, in Prayagraj, Saturday

heavy rains at isolated locations in the state on Monday and Tuesday.

According to the State Emergency Operation Centre (SEOC), 77 water supply schemes and 104 transformers were also disrupted as of Saturday morning.

Since the monsoon began on June 30, 65 people have died in rain-related incidents so far, including 14 in landslides and one in flash floods. The state has suffered losses totalling Rs 834 crore, officials said.

In Kerala, rains prevailed on Saturday, and although floodwaters are receding gradually in many areas, hundreds of people remain in relief camps as many roads and houses are still flooded.

The Upper Kuttanad and Kuttanad regions of Alappuzha and interior areas of Kottayam district continued to bear the brunt of the flooding, though water levels had started receding at several places, officials said.

Floodwaters were receding

Highlights

» In Assam, more than 1.55 lakh people remained affected by floods, with the toll in this year's deluge reaching 98 with one more fatality, officials said

» Major roads, including the Alappuzha-Changanassery road, remained inundated, disrupting traffic in the region

in eight districts -- Kasaragod, Kannur, Wayanad, Kozhikode, Thrissur, Kottayam, Pathanamthitta and Alappuzha -- on Saturday as a precautionary measure.

Local self-government institutions, revenue officials and elected representatives have been asked to facilitate the evacuation of vulnerable residents to relief camps wherever necessary.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast rain and thundershowers at several locations in western Uttar Pradesh and isolated areas in the eastern parts of the state over the next 24 hours.

Officials have also issued a warning of heavy rain in certain locations in eastern Uttar Pradesh. A few places in Punjab and Haryana received rain during the day, including Ludhiana, Patiala, Pathankot, Bathinda, Hisar, Rohtak, Bhiwani, Sirsa and Gurugram. More than 50 places in Haryana's Faridabad were waterlogged on Saturday as relentless rains over the past 24 hours.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress and BJP sparred on Saturday over the women's quota and delimitation bills after Rahul Gandhi said that no country can be successful if its women do not express themselves, prompting Parliamentary Affairs minister Kiren Rijiju to call it a "visible change of heart" and express the hope that the Opposition party will support the proposed legislation "unconditionally".

Responding to Rijiju's comments on X, Gandhi hit back, saying, "Mr Rijiju, who would know better than you, as the Minister of Parliamentary Affairs, that the Women's Reservation Bill 2023 has already been passed unanimously, with the full support of the Congress."

"The question is why has it still not been implemented even after three years, and why do you now want to unnecessarily link it to delimitation?" Gandhi asked in a post on X.

"Implement the 2023 law. Without any conditions", he

'Mr Rijiju, who would know better than you, as the Minister of Parliamentary Affairs, that the Women's Reservation Bill 2023 has already been passed unanimously, with the full support of the Congress'

added.

Responding to Gandhi's retort, Rijiju said the Congress leader knows "very well" that the reservation of seats for women in the House of the People and Legislative Assembly of the State is provided in the Constitution (106th Amendment) Act, 2023.

He said that Gandhi also knows that it shall come into effect after an exercise of delimitation is undertaken based on the census figures published after the year 2023, which

means the census figures published after the year 2026.

"The exercise for publishing the census figures after the year 2026 is currently underway. However, this may take substantial time due to the caste-based census to be finally published. In view of this, it may result in considerable delay in the implementation of women reservation, at least not before the 2034 General Elections," the senior BJP leader said.

Therefore, to implement the women reservation at the next general elections in 2029, the delimitation exercise needs to be undertaken at the earliest, based on the latest available Census figures, as published, he added.

Rijiju said the implementation methodology has been proposed under the Delimitation Bill 2026, introduced in the Lok Sabha along with the amendments to the Constitution.

However, the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, which was introduced for this purpose, has been defeated, the minister said.

Youth made to generate data for money-minting industrialists, stuck in 'chakravyuh', says Rahul

PRAYAGRAJ: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday said India's youths are the country's greatest strength as he spoke about their "dard (pain), data, and dault (wealth)" to attack the BJP and the RSS.

Addressing the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme at KP Ground here, Gandhi said, "You are the power and pride of India. When I say this, I am talking about every Indian citizen."

He added, "This evening I want to speak to you about dard, data, and dault."

While there is much talk about America, China and Russia, "India's youths are unparalleled," he said.

In his speech, Gandhi, who wore a half-sleeve pink shirt, throwing an uncharacteristic dash of colour against his usual



white, touched upon several topics, from AI and data gathering to the BJP-RSS combine, which he accused of holding sway over young people's minds.

The Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha said India has a big chunk of young population and the data it generates would be the key driver of the country's economy in the 21st

century.

"India has the youth and the maximum data in the world. Youth plus data equals the 21st century economy," he said.

Gandhi said that AI depends on data generated by people, and while this data belongs to the country's youth, its economic benefits are going to large corporations.

"Data is yours, youth potential is yours, but the system has trapped you in a 'chakravyuh'," he said.

"You are told to watch as many reels as you want, send as many WhatsApp messages as you want and watch or make as many Instagram reels as you want, but this is the addiction of the 21st century," he said.

Gandhi pointed at images of industrialist Gautam Adani, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, and RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat behind him on a screen, and said, "Data is yours, pain is yours, but wealth is theirs? This is the system."

The Congress leader said that Adani's income increased 30 times in the last 10 years, and alleged a quid pro quo with the government.

MP0ST

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IMPHAL: In a major step towards restoring peace and normalcy in Manipur, Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh and Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen on Saturday announced that national highways in the state will be reopened for free movement of people from all communities.

Singh made the announcement during his visit to Kukimajority Kangpokpi district, where he inaugurated several development projects.

Movement on National Highway 2 (Imphal-Dimapur) and NH-37 (Imphal-Silchar) has been severely affected for sections of the population since ethnic violence broke out in the state in May 2023. Both highways pass through Kangpokpi



district.

On his arrival at Kangpokpi, Singh was welcomed by Kipgen, Saitu MLA Haokholet, Deputy Commissioner, SP and other senior officials.

Inaugurating various development projects, Singh said Manipur had a history spanning nearly 3,000 years and that its boundaries had been shaped by contributions from all communities.

He said people from different communities had made sacrifices to safeguard the state's territory.

"Because of the conflict that has happened, future generations have been affected. To reduce that effect, Imphal-Dimapur bus services will resume very shortly for all communities," Singh said.

Singh said it was unfortunate that some vested-interest groups

were trying to create confusion among people, but stressed that there was a solution to every crisis.

He urged members of all communities to trust and support one another and said people should first consider themselves Indians and then Manipuris. The chief minister said India's development would remain incomplete without the development of the North-east and Manipur's progress would be incomplete without the development of Kangpokpi district.

While inaugurating a dialysis unit at the Kangpokpi district headquarters, Singh said everyone should forgive and forget and stressed that the government was taking the situation arising from the conflict seriously.

From Page 1

PM

Referring to the semiconductor sector, he said when the government took steps in this direction, some people questioned whether India would be able to do it.

"But today, production has begun at the first semiconductor unit. I firmly believe that from chips to ships, everything will be made here by your hands," the PM said.

Over 3,000 graduating students, including 587 PhD scholars, were conferred their degrees at the convocation ceremony.

The Prime Minister said he wished girls were also there among the medalists and awardees at IIT Delhi's convocation, emphasising the need for greater female participation in academic excellence.

"Because you are not merely receiving a degree; you are leaving here with dreams of doing a lot for the country," Modi said while addressing the graduating students of IIT Delhi.

Congratulating the students to whom he gave medals and awards for their achievements, he said, "It would have been even better if there had been one or two daughters. Sorry. Why just one or two? There should have been a lot more of them."

Recognising outstanding academic excellence, the Prime Minister presented the institute's most prestigious honours, including the President's Gold Medal, Director's Gold Medal, Shankar Dayal Sharma Gold Medal, and Perfect Ten Gold Medals to meritorious students.

Warning the graduates against the toxic distractions of the social media era, the Prime Minister urged them to avoid comparing their salaries, placements, or startup milestones with their peers. He counselled them to prioritise their mental and physical well-being while focusing strictly on self-improvement.

"Remember, life is absolutely not a leader-board; your real race

is not with anyone else, it is with yourself," Modi said.

Encouraging the students to deeply cherish their current moments, he humorously referenced campus memories, including inter-hostel rivalries across Kumaon, Ara, Kara, Vindhy, Nilgiri, Kailash, and Himadri, alongside local culinary favourites like Jia Sarai's Poha and Satpura mess Parathas.

"In the coming times when you will have massive responsibilities, the memories of this place will definitely energise you," Modi said. Expressing deep gratitude towards the institutional support system, he urged the graduating class to recognise their peers, professors, mentors, and support staff as lifelong assets who effectively became their surrogate families.

The Prime Minister also inaugurated Param Pragma, an AI-powered high-performance supercomputing facility established at the IIT Delhi's Sonipat Campus.

The state-of-the-art facility is expected to significantly enhance the institute's capabilities in AI, data science, advanced computing and interdisciplinary research. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

TN MPs

Also, TVK's friendly parties, the CPI and CPI(M) which support the government, took part in the meeting.

In total, 19 MPs supporting the TVK government participated.

Briefing reporters on the deliberations, VCK chief and MP, Thol Thirumavilavan said that all the Parliamentarians presented their views.

The VCK chief said: "We have unanimously passed a resolution. The (proposed) delimitation exercise must be dropped. The current total count of 543 (Lok Sabha seats) must continue. The seat allocation for the states must also continue as it is. That means, if we have 39 MPs in Tamil Nadu, that number must continue. This very consensus has been passed as a resolution in this meeting.

"The idea of increasing it to 50 per cent for all states or the stance of increasing the number based on population should not happen;

that is the resolution adopted in this meeting. All the Members of Parliament presented their views on this basis."

Though the DMK and AIADMK may have boycotted the meeting, Thirumavilavan said he believed that they would also take the same stand to oppose delimitation.

Speaking to reporters after taking part in the meeting, Congress MP Karti Chidambaram said the quality of democracy will not improve with a larger parliament.

Chidambaram said: "We are very clear that the number of MPs in the Lok Sabha must be frozen at 543. This freeze must continue and the distribution among the states in the same ratio as it is today, must continue and Tamil Nadu must have 39 members within a 543 member house."

Congress MP Jothamani said the chief minister listened to the views of the MPs from the state. It was decided that the delimitation bill in whatever form the Centre may present -- including an increase of about 50 per cent for each state -- will be disastrous and hence must be opposed. She said the delimitation exercise will prove to be detrimental to the interests of the nation, Tamil Nadu and democracy.

Eleven Congress MPs, two MPs each from CPI, CPI(M) and the VCK; one MP each from the MDMK and IUML took part. DMK's alliance parties, MNM and DMDK, which have one RS MP each, did not take part.

AIADMK, which has four MPs in the Upper House and its ally the PMK, which has one MP, also in the RS, did not participate. The DMK has 22 Lok Sabha and 8 Rajya Sabha MPs.

Congress veteran leader P Chidambaram was among the participants. Marxist party's Su Venkatesan, MDMK's Durai Vaiko were among others who participated.

Narela

Hassan (Karnataka): An anShe died at the scene," a senior police officer said.

The WagonR driver suffered minor injuries in the accident and was provided medical treatment.

No other serious injuries have been reported so far.

Following the accident, a police team from Narela police station reached the spot and initiated an investigation.

"A case under relevant sections relating to the fatal road accident is being registered at Narela police station. The woman's body has been sent for post-mortem," the police said.

Investigators are examining the sequence of events leading up to the crash, including the position and movement of the three vehicles involved.

The driver's statements and other persons who may have witnessed the collision are likely to be recorded as part of the probe.

The police are also examining CCTV footage from the surrounding area to ascertain the speed and movement of the Mercedes and WagonR before the collision and determine how the accident occurred.

The exact circumstances that led to the head-on collision, including whether any traffic violation or other factor was involved, will be established during the investigation, the officer said.

J'khand

"Demands of protesting aspirants are genuine; we will place these before Chief Minister Hemant Soren," state minister Sanjay Prasad Yadav, who is a member of the panel set up by the government, said after the back-to-back meetings.

The ruling JMM's students' wing Jharkhand Chhatra Morcha (JCM) placed five demands before the government panel, including the cancellation of the 14th Jharkhand PSC Civil Services Examination.

The NSUI placed six demands before the government, including a CID probe into all JPSC and JSSC examinations under doubt within 90 days and the setting up of Jharkhand Testing Agency (JTA) on the lines of the National Testing Agency, its spokesperson Sanjiv Shah said.

Adivasi Chhatra Sangh leader Kartik Oraon said, "We demanded inclusion of tribal and regional languages as qualifying

papers in the recruitment examinations, besides cancellation of the tests in which irregularities were found."

The government panel's first meeting was with Mahto's grouping, JPSC JSSC Candidates' Forum, and it lasted around two hours.

"The government assured us of a quick decision to resolve the issues raised by us. However, our protests will continue until all our demands, including cancellation of the 14th JPSC exam, are met," a leader of the forum said.

State minister Dipika Pandey Singh said the talks were held in a positive atmosphere and recruitment discrepancies explained by students will be resolved soon.

Higher and Technical Education Minister Sudhivya Kumar said the government has issued an email ID, jpssc.jssc.feedback@gmail.com, seeking suggestions from aspirants on reforming the recruitment processes.

The government undertook the parleys as the protest over the paper leaks entered its 15th day.

"We have been demanding immediate cancellation of the 14th Jharkhand PSC Civil Services Examination, and all exams conducted by that agency," Mahto said.

He said since the students have been protesting peacefully for over two weeks, the state government should fulfil their demands immediately.

"They should not procrastinate on it. How the government responds to the demands will be interesting to see. If the government had fulfilled the demands on Friday after the talks they held with the 10-member delegation of students, there would be no need for the meeting today, because our demands are almost the same," Mahto said.

"My health condition is deteriorating day by day. Blood pressure and sugar levels are dropping. The doctor informed me about a chest infection and advised hospital admission. If these conditions continue, it will be dangerous for me. I am only able to listen, think, and speak slowly," he added.

A delegation of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) visited the protest site at Jaipal Singh Stadium and extended their support.

The group, led by CJP core committee member Mukesh,

interacted with members of the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, who have been on a hunger strike for the past five days.

"The CJP stands with the students of Jharkhand. We are not a political group. Wherever students face injustice and are deprived of their rights, we stand by them. We support the students' demand for transparency in the recruitment examination in Jharkhand," Mukesh said.

He was accompanied by Akshay, Ram Jakhar, Dr Nitin and Ajay, among others.

Meanwhile, a day after the assembly march in Ranchi, members of the All India Students' Association (AISA) set up a separate platform at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium to intensify their protest.

AISA president Neha Bora, who faced an "ink attack" during the assembly march, briefly joined the protest and raised slogans demanding cancellation of the 14th JPSC and JSSC-CGL examinations.

"We may be fighting from separate platforms, but our demands are the same, including cancellation of the 14th JPSC and JSSC-CGL examination, ensuring transparency and fixing responsibilities," AISA Ranchi president Vijay Kumar said.

The protesters have demanded an independent probe into the alleged irregularities, either by the CBI or a panel of retired high court judges from outside the state.

As many as 19 people have so far been arrested in connection with alleged irregularities in the JPSC examinations, while former JPSC chairman L Khianget has been questioned four times since July 28.

UPI

The statement further said that it was required for market expansion and self-sustainability.

It is necessary to increase competition by encouraging more companies to expand their operations, which requires a self-sustaining revenue model, it said.

Reliance on subsidies alone is not viable for the next wave of growth, it said, adding that a balanced framework is required to

ensure that UPI remains robust, inclusive, and future-ready.

Addressing concerns on narratives like external influences may be driving policy changes, the statement said, this is unfounded, completely false and misleading.

If external pressure had been a factor, the government would not have introduced UPI in 2016 or made it free of charge for both merchants as well as citizens since January 2020 and ensured that it became the world's largest real time interoperable payment system, it said.

The amendment should therefore be viewed in the context of the Government's broader objective of ensuring that India's digital payment infrastructure remains sustainable, competitive, innovative and capable of serving the country's rapidly expanding digital economy, it said.

UPI is India's own innovation, and the government remains committed to keeping it free for citizens while ensuring its sustainability for decades to come, it added.

India now stands at the cusp of the next wave of digital payments growth, it said, adding that to expand UPI further into rural and semi-urban areas and maintain competitiveness, the UPI ecosystem must be self-sustainable and affordable.

The amendment to the PSS Act is a forward-looking step to ensure that UPI continues to thrive as a secure, affordable, inclusive, and globally recognised payment system, it said.

Since its launch in 2016-17, the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has transformed India's digital economy into one of the most inclusive and dynamic payment ecosystems in the world, it said.

What began as a bold experiment in real-time, interoperable payments has now become a global benchmark, processing billions of transactions every month and reaching deep into the fabric of everyday life, it said.

Today, it said, UPI has grown into the world's largest real-time payment system, processing 2,366 crore transactions worth Rs 29.9 lakh crore in July 2026 alone. UPI is now also live in 11 foreign countries, and many other countries have shown interest. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

'CASE BACKLOG REDUCED FROM PAST DECADES'

Dialogue, dignity, inclusion essential for effective access to justice: CJI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

INDORE: Dialogue, dignity and inclusion are essential for effective access to justice, and a true legal aid means “people spoken to and not merely spoken at”, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said on Saturday.

Speaking to reporters after a programme here, he also stated that the backlog of cases in the country has decreased significantly over the last decade.

Addressing the Western Zone Regional Conference of the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA), he said that the objective of legal aid is not merely to dispose of cases, but also to ensure respectful treatment of individuals.

Access to justice begins with dialogue, the CJI said, stressing that appropriate legal solutions should be provided to people based on their specific problems.



A Border Security Force (BSF) personnel stands guard along the Srinagar-Leh National highway, in Ganderbal district

The grievances of different communities should be heard in their own languages, he said.

Describing the volunteers associated with legal services authorities as part of a “judicial army,” the CJI said they play a crucial role in taking government schemes to the grassroots level.

He urged the volunteers to assist victims in securing justice in a manner that upholds

dignity and inclusivity.

“Dialogue, dignity and inclusion -- I do not read these words as slogans for a banner. I read them as an accurate description of what legal aid looks like when it actually works: people spoken to and not merely spoken at, treated as citizens and not mere case numbers, and reached wherever they are, rather than expected to find their own way to us,” the

CJI said.

Access to justice has never been built by laws alone, but it begins with a conversation, he further said.

Every legal aid application starts with someone narrating a problem, every mediation begins with parties agreeing to listen, and a legal awareness programme succeeds only when institutions first understand the realities of the people they seek

Highlights

- » Objective of legal aid is not merely to dispose of cases, but also to ensure respectful treatment of individuals, said CJI
- » The grievances of different communities should be heard in their own languages, CJI said

PTI

HM must speak on police excesses, PM on ‘chanda chori’ issue: Cong

Ramesh alleges that the ‘boastful duo full of bluff and bluster’ has now been exposed as ‘cowardly’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Closer Look

- » ‘The Union Home minister has refused to come to both Houses and give a statement on police brutalities on protesting youth and students, especially on July 20’
- » PM must speak on the ‘Chanda Chori Aastha Dhoka’ by the very Trust whose creation he had so grandly announced on the floor of the Lok Sabha on February 5, 2020, said Ramesh

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Saturday said Parliament has not functioned for 15 consecutive days because Home minister Amit Shah lacks the courage to face MPs and answer queries on police ‘brutality’ against students and Prime Minister Narendra Modi has not spoken on the ‘chanda chori’ issue.

In a post on X, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh alleged that the “boastful duo full of bluff and bluster” has now been exposed as “cowardly”.

“Parliament has not functioned normally for 15 consecutive days for one and only one reason: The Union Home minister has refused to come to both Houses and give a statement on police brutalities on protesting youth and students, especially on July 20,” Ramesh said in his post.

On July 20, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) ‘Sansad Chalo’ march to Parliament had turned

students protesting the NEET paper leak in the national capital last month.

These actions are directly under his charge and control, he said. “His continued absence is unprecedented,” the he noted.

“Parliament has another four days in this session. The Union Home minister must first speak on police excesses. The Prime Minister must speak on the ‘Chanda Chori Aastha Dhoka’ by the very Trust whose creation he had so grandly announced on the floor of the Lok Sabha on February 5, 2020. His hand-picked Trust has betrayed the trust and faith of all Indians, and he cannot remain silent on it,” the Congress leader said.

Since the Monsoon Session began on July 20, Congress and other Opposition parties have stalled proceedings in both Houses of Parliament over the issues of police action against protesting students and the alleged Ram temple donation theft.

violent with clashes erupting between police and students.

The Congress leader said Shah comes to his chamber and sits for long hours but lacks the courage to face MPs in the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha to answer questions about the Delhi Police’s actions against

Ensuring safe, smooth mobility for citizens is govt’s top priority: Saini

‘Contractors failing to complete works within timeframe would be penalised’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Saturday said that ensuring safe, smooth and uninterrupted mobility for citizens is the government’s foremost priority.

While reviewing the status of 2025-26 road works projects at a meeting with senior officers of 10 key departments at Haryana Niwas, Chandigarh, the Chief Minister directed officers concerned to ensure that all road construction, widening and repair works across the state are completed within the stipulated timelines, with no compromise on either quality or the pace of execution.

Officers from PWD, HSAMB, Panchayati Raj Department, FMDA, GMDA, SMDA, PMDA, HSVP, HSIIDC and ULBA attended the meeting.

Reviewing the functioning of the ‘Hamari Sadak’ mobile App, the Chief Minister directed officers to ensure that complaints lodged by citizens regarding potholes and damaged roads are addressed promptly and on priority.

He directed that potholes be filled without delay and that reports of the repair work carried out must mandatorily be uploaded on the App.

He made it clear that any officer or employee found negligent in resolving complaints or uploading the action taken would face strict disciplinary



Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini presiding over a meeting with officers and Sugar Mill Operators, at Chandigarh

MPOST

action.

The Chief Minister directed the Public Works Department and other concerned agencies to ensure mapping of all roads in the State, so that an accurate record of the condition and maintenance of each road is available.

Taking a firm stand against delays in construction works, CM Saini said contractors failing to complete works within the stipulated timeframe would be penalised. Those found compromising on prescribed quality standards would face registration of an FIR and blacklisting.

Meanwhile, while reviewing the functioning of the Haryana State Federation of Cooperative Sugar Mills on Saturday, the CM directed that unnecessary stoppages during mill operations should be minimised and timely maintenance of machinery and advance availability of essential spare parts should be ensured.

‘TRANSPARENT RECRUITMENT PROCESS REPLACED OLD SYSTEM’ Mann hands over appointment letters to 866 youths

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann handing over 866 more appointment letters handed over in Mohali on Saturday, taking the total number of government jobs provided in just four-and-a-half years to 69,094.

The Chief Minister said the transparent recruitment process had replaced the old system where cash and recommendations were considered essential for securing a government job.

The Chief Minister pointed out that the growing confidence of the youth in the system and the declining trend of migration abroad reflected the impact of providing opportunities on the basis of merit.

Highlighting Punjab’s progress in education, he said the state had surpassed Kerala to

Takeaways

- » Highlighting Punjab’s progress in education, Mann said the state had surpassed Kerala to rank first in the country
- » Our government has so far provided 69,094 government jobs with complete transparency, said CM Mann

rank first in the country, with 882 government school students clearing NEET (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test) serving as proof of the transformation.

Sharing a few snippets from this occasion, CM Mann stated on X: “Today, appointment letters were handed over to 866 youth in Mohali. Our government has so far provided 69,094 government jobs with complete transparency. The confidence of the youth in the system has increased, while the trend of moving abroad has declined.”

“In education, Punjab has

today surpassed Kerala to rank first in the country. The success of 882 government school students in NEET is proof of this. The potential of our youth is immense; we are only providing them with the right direction. The wings are yours, and we will provide you with the sky. Congratulations to everyone,” the post concluded.

Addressing the gathering after distributing the appointment letters, CM Mann said, “These 866 appointments include 636 candidates of the Health & Family Welfare Department, including 614 Staff Nurses and other staff

comprising 03 Pharmacists, 13 Multi-purpose Health Workers (Male), 02 Ward Attendants, 01 Class-IV employee and 03 Sweepers. Besides, 101 candidates have been appointed in Sugarfed, 57 as Junior Auditors, 51 in the Defence Services Welfare Department, 11 in the Cooperative Department and 10 candidates as Law Officers in the Home Department.”

Speaking about the recruitment process, the Chief Minister said, “Hard work and dedication have been the sole criteria for selection. Gone are the days when jobs were given on the basis of bribery or recommendations. Today, the state government gives jobs to eligible candidates. All appointments have been made purely on the basis of merit, transparency and fairness, without any recommendation or political influence.”

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Former Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda has instructed Congress members to remain fully vigilant regarding the SIR (Special Intensive Revision) process while addressing a state-level party workshop on SIR held in Sonipat.

Hooda also raised serious questions regarding the law-and-order situation under the BJP government.

He noted that incidents such as open firing in Dadri and a dacoity in Kurukshetra have created an atmosphere of panic across the state. The manner in which miscreants committed a crime right in front of a police station clearly indicates that they have no fear of the law.

The Congress party’s objective is clear: no fake votes should



be registered, and no genuine votes should be deleted, said Hooda.

Responding to questions from journalists, Hooda said that the Election Commission and the BJP are colluding to rig elections.

He stated that this manipulation was evident in the results from Haryana, and continuous complaints are being received regarding the rigging of voter lists through the SIR process. Based on complaints from party agents, the leadership is consistently raising these issues with election officials.

RULE OUT BJP SWITCH NCPI MPs Abu Taher, Khalilur Rahaman ambiguous on party affiliation

KOLKATA: NCPI MPs Abu Taher and Khalilur Rahaman on Saturday refuted insinuations about joining the BJP, maintaining that Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla continues to recognise them as parliamentarians of the Trinamool Congress.

They are among 20 rebel TMC MPs who parted ways with the Mamata Banerjee-led party to merge with the lesser-known Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) weeks after the West Bengal Assembly election.

However, Birla is yet to formally

recognise them as NCPI MPs. A day after MPs Khalilur Rahaman, Yusuf Pathan and Abu Taher Khan attended a breakfast meeting hosted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi for MPs of several alliance partners, Rahaman and Khan refused to divulge their political plans. The trio had maintained that they were not part of the NDA.

Taher and Rahaman met with West Bengal Chief Minister Sudendu Adhikari at the state secretariat here on Saturday.

Interacting with reporters

later, Taher said, “The Lok Sabha Speaker is still addressing us as All India Trinamool Congress (AITC) MPs. When we speak in Parliament, AITC is mentioned alongside our names.

On whether they would continue with the party in the future or choose another political path, Khan replied, “Only time will tell.”

Asked specifically whether they were joining the BJP, Khan ruled it out. “No, we are not joining the BJP. We will remain with the NCPI,” he said.

Cong to form govt in U'khand, asserts Kharge

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Saturday asserted that his party would form the government in Uttarakhand in the upcoming Assembly elections, promising to accommodate Agniveers against vacant government posts and restore the Old Pension Scheme (OPS).

Kharge launched a broad attack on the BJP, flagging the police crackdown on protesting students in Delhi, recruitment examination paper leaks in Uttarakhand and irregularities involving temple donations.

Kharge said the country’s education and employment systems had been “completely destroyed.” He cited the National Education Policy 2020, noting that while the govt had envisaged bringing 50 per cent of students under vocational training by 2025, only around two per cent of the target had been achieved.

“India produces around 50 lakh graduates annually, while only 28 lakh graduate-level jobs are created. This means 22 lakh young people’s dreams are shattered every year,” he said.

Railways merges Express services to strengthen connectivity between Chitrakoot-Pratapgarh

NEW DELHI: The Railways on Saturday announced to merge the services of the 14109/14110 Chitrakutdham Karwi-Kanpur Central Express and 14123/14124 Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh-Kanpur Central Express into a single service operating between Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh and Chitrakutdham Karwi. According to an official statement, the decision has been taken to improve rail connectivity in Uttar Pradesh.

Now the 14123/14124 Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh-Chitrakutdham Karwi Express, the merged train service, would provide direct rail connectivity between the points Chitrakoot, Pratappgarh and Lucknow, making unnecessary the practice of changing trains at Kanpur Central. In addition, the new train is expected to alleviate the problem of overcrowding on the Kanpur-Pratapgarh route.

The train would be expanded from 12 to 24 coaches.

In an official communiqué,



it was stated that the improved train service would link some of the important religious and cultural centres of Uttar Pradesh, which include Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh, Chilibila, Maa Chandrika Devi Dham Antu, Amethi, Gauriganj, Jais, Fursatganj, Rae Bareilly, Bachhrawan, Lucknow, Kanpur Central, Banda, Atarra, and Chitrakutdham Karwi.

Moreover, Chitrakoot is one of the most important religious and cultural sites of the Bundelkhand region. The direct linking of this site with Lucknow and Pratappgarh is supposed to facilitate travel for pilgrims and tourists, apart from benefiting travellers who come to these sites for education, medical reasons, employment opportunities, commerce, and administration.

Journey behind chair: IAS, IPS officers to inspire UP students

The idea is to take career guidance beyond textbooks

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: For thousands of students sitting in classrooms across Uttar Pradesh, the person walking in one day may not be a teacher, but an IAS, IPS or IFS officer carrying years of experience, failures, struggles and lessons from a journey that eventually led to one of the country’s most coveted careers.

The Yogi Adityanath government is now planning to bring such experiences directly to intermediate-level students. Under a new initiative, young officers of the Indian Administrative Service, Indian Police Service and Indian Forest Service posted in districts will visit at least one school every month and interact with students about careers, competitive examinations, higher education and life beyond school.

The idea is to take career guidance beyond textbooks and coaching centres and allow students to hear directly from officers who have themselves faced competitive examinations, uncertainty and difficult choices.

Key Points

- » UP govt is now planning to bring such experiences directly to intermediate-level students
- » The govt has specifically asked that these sessions should not become formal speeches

The government believes that these interactions can give students something that a conventional career lecture often cannot provide: a realistic understanding of what it takes to pursue a goal and the confidence to believe that it is achievable.

Additional Chief Secretary, Secondary Education, Partha Sarathi Sen Sharma has directed officials to ensure effective monitoring of the programme. Divisional commissioners will periodically review its implementation, while district inspectors of schools will coordinate between schools and officers to ensure that the visits are conducted properly.



Union Home minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah on Saturday visited Tamil Nadu to undertake a pilgrimage to two important shrines in the state.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

UNAUTHORISED DEPOSIT SCHEME: ED ATTACHES RS 15.25 CRORE

GUWAHATI: GUWAHATI: The Directorate of Enforcement (ED), Guwahati Zonal Office, has provisionally attached assets valued at around Rs 15.25 crore in a money laundering case involving Rishiraj Gogoi, Joy Modak and others, promoters of M/s GoMillions LLP. The ED has initiated the money laundering probe against Gogoi, Modak and others in terms of section 2 (l) of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, in respect of alleged unauthorised deposit collection scheme popularly known as ‘TradeBull’.

CISF AIRPORT SECTOR, IIT ROPAR SIGN MOU TO BOLSTER AVIATION CYBERSECURITY

NEW DELHI: The CISF Airport Sector and IIT Ropar have collaborated to bolster the cybersecurity infrastructure of the aviation sector and provide specialised training to personnel handling the security of this critical sector of the economy. A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to this effect was signed by the two entities on August 7, 2026, initiating the process to hold a six-week residential Cyber Security Training Programme for the personnel of CISF on a no-cost basis. The training programme has been designed as an institutional tie-up between CISF and IIT Ropar SCALE Foundation. The MoU was signed by IIT Ropar Director Rajeev Ahuja and CISF IG/Airport Sector-I Senthil Avoodai Krishna Raj S.



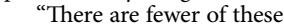
Zelenskyy visits Serbia as Russian attacks on Kyiv region kill four

Pakistan-Saudi-Turkiye defence pact likely to cut US role in West Asia

Defence analyst Abdullah Hameed Gul, son of a former ISI chief, said the pact has emerged against the backdrop of growing doubts in the Gulf region about the US' ability to provide security guarantees to regional allies. "The US had 27 military bases in the Gulf

Two drones spotted over German military base after drone with explosives found at key airport

The military said the Euskirchen police department has opened an investigation. The police did not immedi-

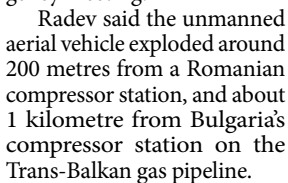


The talks in Belgrade came after multiple Russian drones destroyed the home of a family in the Brovary district, north-east of Kyiv, killing a 3-year-

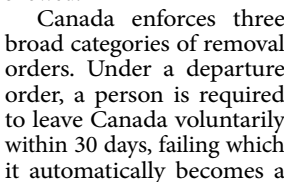
In its daily report, Ukraine's air force said it had downed or intercepted 135 of 151 drones launched by Russia overnight. The attack also involved six ballistic missiles and other

Moscow is exploiting Ukraine's critical shortage of interceptors for the US-made Patriot systems, the sole air defence weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down ballistic missiles.

Drone likely from Ukraine explodes in Bulgaria near gas pipeline close to Romania's border



Canada deported 3,323 Indians in first half of 2026, data shows



IS-linked group kills at least 13 in Congo village

It is one of numerous groups operating in Congo, routinely attacking civilians. In July 2025, the group killed 66 people in eastern Congo in what the United Nations called a “blood-bath.”

12-year-old girl dies after Thailand school shooting, death toll rises to 8

try said. The school had posted a message on Facebook Friday seeking blood donations

The young girl's body is still to be released. Wiroon Supasingsiripreecha, head of

told Thai media that they were unaware of any troubles he might have been facing. AGENCIES

Iran says strait won't open until United States corrects behaviour

The US must never threaten Iran again, the statement said & must permanently

Iran earlier said it was close to reaching a deal with Oman to manage the strait

end the war with Iran and its armed allies in the region. The US must lift the naval blockade of Iranian ports and withdraw its military from the area. It also must “completely compensate” Iran for war damage, lift sanctions and “unconditionally” release frozen assets.

Iran earlier said it was close to reaching a deal with Oman to manage the strait, which runs between the two countries. Oman, a mediator Gulf Arab country which has said relatively little on the talks, said in a statement Saturday that the discussions were ongoing "in a positive and constructive atmosphere," and condemned attacks on ships on the strait.

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING
THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahzad @ Mulla, S/o. Taslim, R/o.H.No. A-58, Gali No.13, IG Colony, Nangloi, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.232/2021 U/S. 356/379/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Hari Nagar, West District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Shahzad @ Mulla** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shahzad @ Mulla** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shahzad @ Mulla**, accused of **FIR No. 232/2021 U/S. 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S Hari Nagar, West District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.

By Order, **Moksha Bains-I**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II, West
Court No.31, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11026/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

DOBAI: Iran's pointbrou-like body known as the Supreme National Security Council said the Strait of Hormuz will not be open until the United States "corrects its behaviour", issuing new demands that could shake up talks on a deal to manage the waterway and traffic on it.

Iran's state broadcaster published the statement by the council's secretary, Mohamad Bagher Zolghadr, who is also a commander in the powerful Revolutionary Guard.

The US must never threaten Iran again, the statement said and must permanently

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sunny Nagar S/o** Ravi Nagar R/o Kartar Balmiki Muhalla, Tughlakabad Gaon, New Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 742/2021 U/s 379/356/411 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sunny Nagar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sunny Nagar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sunny Nagar** of under **FIR No. 742/2021 U/s 379/356/411 IPC.**, Registered at **PS: Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.

By Order
Divyam Lila
DP/10917/SE/2026 JMFC-07 (S.E. Distt), Room No. 508
(Court Notice) Saket Court, New Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No: AGC/TRD/T/2026/19 E- Tender Notice Date : 06.08.2026

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No.: AGCTRD1202619 Period of completion : 12 months

Name of work: Modification in OHE due to Construction of 2 Lane ROB No. 157 by increasing Height and Rebuilding of Old ROB at km 83/5-6 between Agra Fort-Igdah Stations.

Approximate Cost: ₹ 50,37,978/- Earnest Money : ₹ 1,00,800/-

Note: (1) For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in (2) Tender can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in upto 15:30 Hrs. on date 31.08.2026. 1818/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: 26/37 Date: 07.08.2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-procurement Tenders.

S. No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	38262624	Articulated Lock Lift Assembly consisting of five items	21228 Nos.	02.09.2026
2	38264219	K-Type Composition Brake Block	43268 Nos.	09.09.2026
3	38261941	Body Side Arrangement complete	96 Nos.	14.09.2026
4	20263022A	SUB KIT IOH-I FOR TAP CHANGER N-32	24 Set.	31.08.2026
5	20262101A	Gear Case Assly.	637 Nos.	02.09.2026
6	80261031	Inhibited Mineral Insulating Transformer Oil Type II	59352 Ltrs.	01.09.2026
7	80264101B	HYD OIL Part No. HLP-68N	175175 Ltrs.	31.08.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. 1825/26 (A)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

SEE SECTION 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Kabun Rabidas S/o** Kangaliya Rabidas R/o Jhuggi Near Gole Chakkar, Netaji Nagar, Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi also at Rajol, Khusida, Malda, West Bengal has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 294/2022 U/s 323/341/34 IPC, P.S. Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kabun Rabidas** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kabun Rabidas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kabun Rabidas** of case **FIR No. 294/2022 U/s 323/341/34 IPC, P.S. Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class -05
13, First Floor, Main Building
Patiala House Courts, Delhi

DP/10433/SW/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: AGC-EL-C-T-03R-2025-26 Date : 06.08.2026

Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const.), North Central Railway, Agra for and behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Name of work with its location : Modification / Shifting of 33KV, 11 KV, 440 Volt Electrical Power Line Over Head Crossing of State Electricity Board/DVYNL by Under Ground XLPE Cable at Various Location in Connection with the Mathura Yard Remodelling & Bhuteshwar Flyover work of Agra Division of North Central Railway

Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 43,52,008.11/- Bid Security : As Per IREPS

Completion Period : 12 Months from the date of issue of acceptance letter including monsoon period., Tender closing date & time : 28.08.2026 upto 15:00 hrs., Validity of offer : 60 days from the date of tender opening. Tenderers can only submit their offer through web portal www.ireps.gov.in in up to 15:00 hrs on 28.08.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1822/26 (D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sharafat Ali S/o** Saukat R/o H.No. C-135, JJ Colony, Sawda PS: Kanjhawla, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 413/2024 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act** at P.S.: Mundka, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Sharafat Ali** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sharafat Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Sharafat Ali** of case **FIR No. 413/2024 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act** of P.S.: Mundka, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West Room No.355
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11018/OD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

L. No. : JHS-ELG-W-T-32-2025-26-RT Date : 06.08.2026

E-Tender Notice

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical (Gen) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:-

Tender No. : JHS-ELG-W-T-32-2025-26-RT Tender value : Rs. 1,68,67,150/- only

Description of work : Electrical/G Work for :- Jhansi : Air conditioning of Service building & other associated work in Jhansi DRM office campus.

Bid Security : Rs. 2,34,300/- only

Closing date of tender : 31.08.2026 (Up to 15:00 Hrs.).

Tenderer will submit the tender online up to 31.08.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.). Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> 1821/26 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

JHS_M_26_07 E-Tender Notice Date: 06.08.2026

On behalf of President of India, DRM (M/JHS, NCR invites "Open E-Tender" through online (E-tendering) for the following work in prescribed format.

E-Tender No.: JHS_M_26_07 Estimated cost of work: 5,53,39,645.36/-

Description of work and place: "Mechanized Washing, Ironing,packaging, transportation & distribution of linen in AC coaches of train originating from KURJ Depot for a period of 03 years.."

Earnest Money: 4,26,70,00/- Time of completion: 36 Months

Tender submission & Closing date and time: 29.08.2026 Closing time 14:00 hrs.

* Online Tender can be submitted upto 14:00 hrs on 29.08.2026. * For full details and submission of bid, please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1819/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Govt. of Jharkhand
Energy Department
Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA)

3rd Floor, S.L.D.C. Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi-834002.
Ph.: 0651-2491161, Fax: 0651-2491165,
E-mail: info@jreda.com,
Website: www.jreda.com

e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No.: 15/JREDA/GCRT/SPV/IT/26-27 Dated: 07.08.2026

1

Name of the work

Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Agencies for "Design, Development, Implementation, Hosting and Operationalization of an IoT-Enabled Vender, Asset and Inventory Management System and IT-Based Performance Monitoring & Evaluation Framework along with 05 (Five) Years of Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Solar Power Projects across the State of Jharkhand.

2

Period of contract

05 (Five) Years

3

Time of completion

06 (Six) Months

4

Date of publication of NIT on website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

14.08.2026 (Friday)

5

Date & time of Pre-bid meeting

20.08.2026 (Thursday) at 1.00 P.M.

6

Last date & time for receipt of online bids

07.09.2026 (Monday) upto 05:00 PM

7

Submission of original copies of Bid fee & EMD through Online via SBI Payment Gateway of Jharkhand Tenders

07.09.2026 (Monday) upto 05:00 PM

8

Technical Bid Opening Date

09.09.2026 (Wednesday) at 3.00 P.M.

9

Name & address of office inviting tender

Director, Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA) 3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai, Doranda, Ranchi- 834002 (Jharkhand)

10

Contact no. of procurement officer

9570086777

11

Helpline no. of e-procurement

0651-3502645

Any corrigendum/addendum can be seen on website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com. Further details can be seen on website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com

Sd/-
Director
JREDA, Ranchi

PR 386987 (Energy)26-27"D

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dhanbad, dt. 05/08/2026 E-Tenders are invited for execution of the following works by Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), E.C. Railway, Dhanbad.

1. E-Tender No: 148-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Zonal contract in Zone No.08 for Horticulture work of Dhanbad Sub-Division under Asstt. Engineer (I), E.C. Rly., Dhanbad. (30.06.2027) Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 7,50,000.00/-

2. E-Tender No: 149-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Repair and construction of road of different colony under IO/W/2/DHN in the jurisdiction of ADEN/1/DHN. 12 (Twelve) months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,01,28,495.62/-

3. E-Tender No: 150-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Replacement of worn out girders of common loop line & up third loop line and replacement of worn out girders of UP & DN GC main Line Ganga Bridge along with replacement of bearing plate & fitting of UP & DN GC girder of Gaya Bridge at DHN. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,72,26,668.12/-

4. E-Tender No: 151-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Repairs road at railway colony BRKA & Diesel colony & Traffic colony at Patratu under ADEN/BRKA. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 64,87,106.24/-

5. E-Tender No: 152-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of 3.0M wide FOB at DIWR & TKS with stair & ramp in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/3/DHN. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 6,82,40,942.22/-

6. E-Tender No: 153-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Improvement of PF Surface & provision of water booth, PF shelter, seating benches, Approach road, waiting hall, parking etc at Telo, CRP, P.J.DE, BHME, PUS, AMLO, BERMO, BKRO, GMIA, DMGR, DNEA, JGBR, CNPR, KMHT under ADEN/2/GMO. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,31,30,247.86/-

7. E-Tender No: 154-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: PTRU:-Provision of HL platform at PTRU (PF No. 2&3). 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,38,12,204.10/-

8. E-Tender No: 155-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of High Level Platform, platform surfacing, PF shelter, seating arrangement and water booths at DIGWAR, ARIGADA, SHANKI, JHANJHITOLI, HUNDUR under ADEN/BRKA. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 6,67,11,064.87/-

9. E-Tender No: 156-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: GMIA & BKRO:- Extension of PF No.3 of Gomia & PF No.2 of Bokaro Thermal station to accommodate full length trains. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,11,32,877.95/-

10. E-Tender No: 157-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Painting of Bridge No.106 A (2x18.30+1x12.20M) between section KRLR-Singrauli with long life painting under SSE/Bridge/OTO in Dhanbad Division. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 32,97,367.92/-

11. E-Tender No: 158-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Changing of rusted members, strengthening of Br.No.187 UP & DN (2x8x18.3) and Br.No.345 UP & DN (2x8x18.3) in GC Section under SSE (Bridge)/Dhanbad. 11 (Eleven) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 3,43,57,120.12/-

12. E-Tender No: 159-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Reconditioning/Resurfacing of Tongue Rail, Point & Crossing in KQR-ARGD & KQR-NGRH section under ADEN/KQR. 12 (Twelve) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 64,94,158.01/-

13. E-Tender No: 160-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: (i) KODERMA-ARIGADA = TRRP - 1,620 Km (from 8 to 9.62 Km) in between PDMA-BARHI Single line & (ii) KODERMA-ARIGADA = TRRP - 1,620 Km (from 9.62 to 11.24 Km) in between PDMA-BARHI Single line under ADEN/KQR.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 73,68,991.94/-

14. E-Tender No: 161-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Repair and upgradation and fixing of Track sign board including station name board in GC section. 06(Six) Months Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 54,71,790.87

15. E-Tender No: 162-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period:Repair of leaky roof treatment in RE colony and European colony at G.M.O. 06 (Six) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 59,95,903.37/-

16. E-Tender No: 163-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Improvement of PF Surface & provision of PF Shed, water booth & seating benches at TORI, MMLN, MGME, RCOT & KOLE under ADEN/LTHR.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,49,99,096.29/-

17. E-Tender No: 164-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of cover shed and other ancillary works at LHS No.2 under ADEN/LTHR.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,27,83,668.41/-

18. E-Tender No: 165-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Dhanbad Division – Provision of track machine siding of length of 300m (approx.) at RAY, MGME, MMLN & G.K.K. under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/1/DHN.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 8,51,83,071.23/-

19. E-Tender No: 166-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Interlocking of 3 Nos. of L.C. Gates having TVU more than 20000 in Dhanbad division. 09 (Nine) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 42,92,104.19/-

20. E-Tender No: 167-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Construction, Improvement and major Upgradation of Store Cum Maintainer's study Rooms with Toilet Facilities under the sections of ASTE/DHN and Interlocking of 1 No. of LC Gate having TVU more than 20000 in Dhanbad Division.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,44,44,517.07/-

21. E-Tender No: 168-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of ramp (with all Divyang facilities) in the FOB of KRLR, OBRA & BXLL station.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 4,07,15,888.77/-

22. E-Tender No: 169-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of ramp (with all Divyang facilities) in the FOB of SKTN, KRLS & ANPR station.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 4,07,15,888.77/-

23. E-Tender No: 170-DHN-2026-27 Name of the work with its location & completion period: Replacement of old PS Tank & CI Tank at Renukut (RNQ) (01 No.) of Dhanbad Division.12 (Twelve) Months. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,71,79,816.64/-

Earnest Money is applicable as shown in www.ireps.gov.in Portal. Date & Time for closing and opening of e-tender: Date of closing of e-tender at 12-00 hours on 31.08.2026. Date of opening of e-tender from 12:30 hrs. on 31.08.2026. Website particulars : www.ireps.gov.in No manual tender will be accepted against e-tendering. Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) East Central Railway / Dhanbad PR/0684/DHN/ENGG/T/26-27/208

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Morish @ Nazim, S/o. Md. Safeek, R/o.: Shiv Mandir,Indrapuri, Loni, Ghaziabad, U.P** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.466/2022 U/s 25 Arms Act** registered at **P.S Vivek Vihar, Shahdara District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Morish @ Nazim** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Morish @ Nazim** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Morish @ Nazim**, accused of **FIR No. 466/2022 U/S 25 Arms Act, P.S Vivek Vihar, Shahdara District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order, Mohit Sharma
Chief Judicial Magistrate
Third Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10978/SHD/2026 JMFC-11, Room No. 138, First Floor
(Court Matter) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Mohd. Munish@Lala S/o Mohd. Khalil R/o Nasbandi Colony Kamal Vihar, Budh Nagar, Near Bangali Masjid, Loni, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in e-FIR/CC No. 241/2011 U/s 392/411/34 IPC PS: **Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Munish@Lala** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Munish@Lala** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd. Munish@Lala** accused of e-FIR/CC No. 241/2011 U/s 392/411/34 IPC PS: **Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
DP/10974/N/2026 JMFC-11, Room No. 138, First Floor
(Court Matter) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

झारखण्ड सरकार
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, जमशेदपुर

ई-अल्पकालिन पुनर्निविदा आगमन सूचना

ई-अल्पकालिन पुनर्निविदा संख्या:- RWD/EE/JSR/STPKG/01/RXVI/2023-24 दिनांक :- 07.08.2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, जमशेदपुर द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र. सं. / फिकेशन संख्या	कार्य का नाम	अंक में	अक्षर में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	टेंडर कॉल सं.
	देबकी चौक से थिरोल तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-4.000 किमी0)	1,26,68,500.00	एक करोड़ छब्बीस लाख अड़सठ हजार पाँच सौ रू0 मात्र		
	गोविन्दपुर जादुगोड़ा रोड से कुलडीहा तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-1.450 किमी0)	79,30,500.00	उनसी लाख तीस हजार पाँच सौ रू0 मात्र		
	पोराहीड बारमुट घाट (धुसुरडीहा) से तलसाई पी.सी.सी. रोड भागा नवागों पड़ा मालकी तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-1.720 किमी0)	1,16,44,800.00	एक करोड़ सोलह लाख चौबीस हजार आठ सौ रू0 मात्र		
	नारदा बलिया मंजी के घर से रीचू हांसदा काशियावेड़ा तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-1.520 किमी0)	1,18,85,000.00	एक करोड़ अठारह लाख पचासी हजार रू0 मात्र		
	T07 से सिलिंग तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-5.700 किमी0)	2,77,54,500.00	दो करोड़ अठारह लाख चौवन हजार साँच सौ रू0 मात्र		
	पोटका प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत उलनसाई L054 PMGSY Road से बारोला तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-1.270 किमी0)	82,73,000.00	बिासी लाख सित्तर हजार रू0 मात्र		
	आर.ई.ओ. रोड से मानिकपुर तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-2.150 किमी0)	1,31,47,500.00	एक करोड़ एकतीस लाख सैंतालीस हजार पाँच सौ रू0 मात्र		
	जायाडीह से बनकाटी तक पथ का विशेष मरम्मत कार्य। (लं-2.600 किमी0)	1,55,53,500.00	एक करोड़ पचपन लाख सिरपन हजार पाँच सौ रू0 मात्र		
	कुल	10,88,57,300.00	दस करोड़ अठारसी लाख सत्तानवन हजार तीन सौ रू0 मात्र		

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि:- 11.08.2026।
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय:- 27.08.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।
4. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि jharkhandtenders.gov.in के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन मोड में स्वीकार की जाएगी।
5. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:- 29.08.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11.30 बजे।
6. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :-कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, जमशेदपुर, ब्लॉक-करनडीह, थाना-परसुडीह, जमशेदपुर, झारखण्ड, पिन-831002।
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं०- 0657-2298902।
8. विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION R.S.PURA

Fresh Short e-NIT No. DRSP/61 of 2026-27 Dated 05-08-2026(2nd Call)

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and State State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of Link road from Fatehpur brahmanna to Faqeer dev shathan (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27)(2nd Call).	PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura	15.00	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	02 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 14-08-2026	"A" , "B" , "C" & "D" Class
2	Improvement of link road to Phian Tibba (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27) (2nd Call).	PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura	15.00	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	02 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 14-08-2026	"A" , "B" , "C" & "D" Class
3	Construction of Link road from main road to h/o of Balwant singh near Brick kiln Dayali Badyal Brahmana (by way of V&M grade II, W&M, BM and SDBC) Part - II (Length= 0.450) (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27). (2nd Call)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura	23	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	03 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 14-08-2026	"A" , "B" "C" Class

Position of AAA :-S.No. 1 to 3 Accorded by District Development Commissioner, Jammu vide order No: 311-DDCJ of 2026 Dated: 10/07/2026
Position of TS :-S.No. 1 to 3 Accorded by Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura vide order No: 24 of July 2026 Dated: 23 of July 2026
Project Authority :-S.No. 1 to 3 (District Development Commissioner, Jammu)
Major Head of Account :-S.No. 1 to 3 (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27(SSY/PWD(R&B) Component)).

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	05-08-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 05-08-2026 to 13-08-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	07-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura
4	Bid submission Start Date	05-08-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	13-08-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	14-08-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. In case mentioned bid opening date happens to be a holiday then Bid shall be opened at the same time on the next working day
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of Treasury Receipt/e-challan in favour of Executive Engineer PWD(R&B) Division R S Pura through Treasury, indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No, and Date and name of work duly crediting to 0059 (Revenue) and Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura at the time of allotment.
2. The date of Treasury Challan, Earnest Money/Bid Security must be between the date of start of bid and Bid Submission End Date. However, if the tender for the same work has been re-invited after 1st or More calls, the bidders who have already bid for that work can re-use the same Treasury Challan/Earnest Money/ Bid Security in the successive calls for the said work provided there should not be any overwriting or forging on the previously uploaded documents.
3. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidders needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender documents. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In the event of bid submission, the modification and consequential submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
4. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site [www.jtenders.gov.in](http://jtenders.gov.in) and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. The date for same shall be intimated separately.
5. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.
6. The earnest money shall be forfeited, if :-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issuance of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07

EVERY MONSOON, ASSAM BRACES FOR ITS NEXT DEVASTATING FLOOD. THIS YEAR, THOUGH, ALONGSIDE THE SWOLLEN BRAHMAPUTRA RIVER HAS EMERGED A NEW POWERFUL CURRENT: ORDINARY INDIANS STEPPING UP TO HELP COMPLETE STRANGERS REBUILD SHATTERED LIVES



India Rises with



MPOST BUREAU

Dawn breaks quietly over a village in Upper Assam. There is no traffic, no school bell, no familiar sounds of another working day. Only water. Endless sheets of muddy water stretch across what, until a few days ago, were homes, courtyards, paddy fields and village roads. On top of a tree near a half-submerged house sits an elderly woman clutching her frightened grandson and a small cloth bag, the only possessions she could save before the Brahmaputra claimed everything else.

Some hours later, the silence is broken. Not by television cameras. Not by political speeches. But by the growl of an SUV inching through a flooded track, carrying sacks of rice, medicines, blankets and drinking water instead of passengers. The young volunteers inside have travelled hundreds of kilometres. They know nobody waiting for them. Yet, someone in that village has been waiting for them all morning.

Hundreds of kilometres away, another Indian begins the day by scanning a QR code printed in a newspaper. A few hundred rupees leave one bank account. Somewhere in Assam, they return as food, medicine and hope. One flood swallowed homes. Another is flooding Assam with strangers carrying hope. That, perhaps, is the real story of Assam this monsoon.

TRAGEDY NORMALISED

Floods in Assam are no longer breaking news. They have become a recurring appointment with tragedy and death. They are now expected, a near norm. And that is greatest tragedy of all. The Brahmaputra has overflowed before. It will overflow again. Every year, relentless monsoons, fragile embankments, riverbank erosion, runoff from neighbouring hills and a changing climate combine to leave vast stretches of the state under water. The names of the affected districts change. The anguish does not.

This year, too, the scale has been staggering. At the height of the crisis, more than 7 lakh people across a dozen districts have been affected, hundreds of villages inundated and tens of thousands of hectares of farmland has disappeared beneath floodwaters. Even as the waters gradually recede, the human suffering has not. As of this weekend, the flood toll has risen untold, while more than 1.42 lakh people continue to remain affected, lives suspended between loss and recovery.

There is something profoundly unsettling about disasters that return with calendar-like regularity. Their predictability should make us better prepared. Instead, it risks making us emotionally accustomed. A tragedy that repeats every year eventually ceases to shock us. It should never cease to shame us.

THE OTHER FLOOD

Yet, if the Brahmaputra carried destruction, another

98

DEATHS

168k+

LIVES AFFECTED

THE SECOND MAP

Every disaster creates two maps. The first is the one we are familiar with. It marks submerged villages, breached embankments, washed-away roads, relief camps and the grim arithmetic of lives lost and families displaced. Governments, disaster management agencies and television channels rely on it to measure the scale of the crisis. The second map is never printed. It traces the journey of online donations, volunteers who travel through the night, trucks carrying food and medicines, students collecting relief material, doctors offering free treatment and strangers who quietly decides that another family's suffering is also their own. It is a map drawn not by rivers or roads, but by compassion.

India has seen this invisible map before. During the devastating Kerala floods of 2018, fishermen abandoned their livelihoods to rescue thousands stranded in flooded neighbourhoods, earning the enduring title of Kerala's Army. Students organised collection drives, restaurants prepared free meals, housing societies became relief centres and citizens across the country contributed money, medicines and essential supplies. The floodwaters divided communities; compassion united them.

Assam is living this same invisible map today. Geography may tell us where one state ends and another

begins. The second map reminds us that in moments of adversity, humanity recognises no such boundaries.



current has carried hope. Across India, donations that began as isolated acts of kindness have gathered into a nationwide movement of compassion. Food, medicines, clothing, drinking water and emergency supplies have flowed towards Assam from people who have never seen the

villages they are helping. Students have organised collection drives. Resident welfare associations have mobilised relief material. Doctors have volunteered medical assistance. Community organisations have transformed schools and halls into temporary

shelters. Young men and women have driven SUVs where trucks could not go, and walked where even vehicles surrendered to the water.

One volunteer network reported having reached more than 40,000 flood-affected families across three districts

on rescue missions, for food distribution, medical camps and rehabilitation support. Every disaster produces two maps. One shows the areas under water. The other shows the reach of human kindness. The first is drawn by rivers. The second by people. The question before us all,

however, is larger than this year's flood. Why does Assam continue to endure a disaster that returns with such relentless regularity? Nature creates floods. Human beings decide whether they become recurring humanitarian disasters. It all boils down to some clear choices: on how

we plan our cities, strengthen our embankments, restore wetlands, manage river basins, protect forests, invest in early-warning systems and prepare communities long before the first clouds gather.

Relief is indispensable. Preparedness is irreplaceable. A nation cannot congratulate itself every year for rescuing the same people from the same tragedy. For compassion is noble, but complacency is not.

Soliloquy: Every year, government agencies publish maps showing submerged districts, damaged roads and breached embankments. Necessary as those maps are, they tell only half the story. The other map cannot be printed. It stretches from apartments in Bengaluru, villages in Punjab, housing societies in Mumbai and college campuses in Guwahati to relief camps across Assam.

It traces the journey of every online donation, every food packet, every volunteer and every silent prayer. One map records the spread of the flood. The other records the reach of India's conscience.

WHAT ASSAM ASKS

There is another reason why Assam matters to every Indian. Not because it floods, but because it asks us a question that no river can answer. Will we remember after the waters recede? History suggests that our finest moments often emerge from our darkest hours. Earthquakes, cyclones, pandemics and floods have repeatedly revealed an India that refuses to stand by while fellow citizens suffer. That instinct deserves celebration. It is one of the country's greatest strengths.

Yet, compassion cannot remain seasonal. If our concern rises with the river and recedes with it, we have mistaken generosity for responsibility. Assam deserves more than annual sympathy. It deserves annual preparedness.

What is the measure of a nation? The answer could well boil down to it being a QR code on a social media page, one that is only a few centimetres wide. Yet, it may be the shortest distance between one Indian's concern and another's survival. Scan it if you can. Share it if you cannot. But when the floodwaters finally retreat, and they will, let us not allow our memory to retreat with them.

Floodwaters are measured in cubic metres. Nations are measured in moments. The true measure of any nation is not how often it responds to a recurring tragedy. It is whether it decides that recurring tragedies are just not acceptable. This week, one flood tested Assam. Another tested India's conscience. The first swallowed homes. The second carried hope. May the day come when the only thing that rises with the monsoon is the Brahmaputra, not another humanitarian crisis. Until that day, India must continue to rise with Assam.

NATURE HAS SUBMERGED VILLAGES IN ASSAM. BUT IT HAS ALSO REVEALED THE extraordinary INSTINCT OF ORDINARY PEOPLE TO HELP EACH OTHER OUT IN TORRID TIMES



WAS IT A MAN-MADE DISASTER?

UNPRECEDENTED RAINS TRIGGERED DEVASTATING FLOODS IN ASSAM. BUT ENVIRONMENTAL DEGRADATION IN THE NAGA HILLS MADE A BAD SITUATION FAR WORSE.

HILLS UNDER SIEGE
DEFORESTATION AND UNCHECKED COAL, STONE AND SAND MINING IN THE NAGA HILLS DESTROY NATURAL BUFFERS AND REDUCE WATER RETENTION.

MORE RUNOFF, MORE DAMAGE
HEAVY RAINS OVER DEGRADED HILLS CAUSE FASTER RUNOFF AND MASSIVE SILT LOAD IN RIVERS AND TRIBUTARIES.

RIVERS OVERFLOW, LIVES LOST
SILT-CHOKED RIVERS EXCEED THEIR CAPACITY, BREACH EMBANKMENTS AND OVERFLOW INTO ASSAM, DESTROYING HOMES AND LIVELIHOODS.

EXPERTS SAY LARGE-SCALE MINING AND DEFORESTATION IN THE NAGA HILLS ACCELERATED RUNOFF AND SILT DEPOSITION, INTENSIFYING FLOODS IN EASTERN ASSAM.



“WHEN WE DAMAGE THE HILLS AND RIVERS, THE FLOODS ARE NOT JUST NATURAL — THEY ARE MAN-MADE”



1
GIANT
OVERLOOKED

4.6
MILLION
REASONS

110
MARKETS
STRONG

ONE OF THE WORLD'S MOST INFLUENTIAL EV COMPANIES HAS BEEN IN INDIA FOR A WHILE. BUT AS THE WORLD DEBATES BYD'S RISE, INDIA'S AUTO CHATTER BARELY NOTICES IT. WHY?



AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

Global Giant India Barely Notices

The automobile industry has always had a curious way of humbling conventional wisdom. In the 1960s and 70s, Japanese cars were largely dismissed as inexpensive imitations that could not hope to match Europe's engineering pedigree or America's manufacturing might. It took just one generation for Toyota and Honda to blow away the wheels from under that perception, setting new global benchmarks for quality, reliability and manufacturing excellence.

The scepticism resurfaced in the 1990s. South Korean manufacturers such as Hyundai and Kia were viewed as budget alternatives, unlikely to challenge the pecking order that the automobile sector seemed to have established. Today, these same Korean firms compete quite comfortably with the world's most respected automotive brands, winning customers on technology, design, safety and innovation, rather than price.

The brand names have changed. The technologies have evolved. But the pattern remains acutely familiar. Every automotive revolution produces a challenger that established markets underestimate, until they no longer can. That is why the story of BYD deserves closer attention.

THE INVISIBLE GIANT

Last year, BYD sold more than 4.6 million new-energy vehicles worldwide, exported over 1 million vehicles and expanded its footprint to more than 110 countries and regions. Those are not the numbers of a niche manufacturer or an ambitious start-up. They are the credentials of a company helping redefine the global automotive industry.

Yet, in India – the world's third-largest automobile market – BYD managed to sell only 5,431 vehicles through 2025. Few companies illustrate the gap between global stature and local visibility more starkly. Outside industry circles, BYD still struggles for mainstream recognition. It remains a company many Indian motorists have heard of only in passing, if at all.

That is surprising, because the global conversation around electric mobility increasingly places BYD among the industry's most consequential players. It is not merely another electric vehicle company. It is one of the companies shaping where the industry is headed.

WEIGHT OF NUMBERS

What puts BYD's scale into perspective, however, is not just its own sales figures; it is what they represent. The company delivered 4.6 million new-energy vehicles in 2025 – more than the total annual car markets of many developed economies combined. It invested billions of dollars in research and development, reinforcing a strategy built not on manufacturing capacity but on relentless technological advancement. For a company that began life as a battery-maker, this transformation into a global automotive powerhouse has been remarkable. And it has been blindingly swift.

The numbers matter because they challenge a long-held assumption about where automotive innovation now resides. For decades, breakthroughs flowed largely from Detroit, Germany or Japan. Today, the centre of gravity is becoming dispersed. Companies such as BYD are demonstrating that leadership in the electric age will be determined by mastery over batteries, software, electronics and integrated manufacturing as much as by traditional automotive engineering. Whether India embraces BYD is a separate question. Recognising the scale of the transformation it represents is not.

BEYOND ELECTRIC CARS

What makes BYD significant is not simply the number of vehicles it sells. Unlike traditional automakers, the company has built an integrated electric mobility ecosystem. It manufactures batteries, electric motors, power electronics, semiconductors and other critical components in-house. In an era when supply-chain disruptions

and rising input costs have become defining challenges, that level of vertical integration provides a huge competitive advantage.

BYD's Blade Battery, for one, is among the industry's more important technological breakthroughs, improving battery packaging, durability and safety while helping address some anxieties that continue to surround EVs. Clearly, BYD is not just assembling electric cars. It is building much of the technology that goes into them. That distinction explains why BYD has grown from an unknown manufacturer into one of the world's most influential auto enterprises in a remarkably short span.

MOST AUTO DISRUPTORS ARE OFTEN DISMISSED BEFORE THEY ARE admired.
INDIA TOO IS IN DANGER OF OVERLOOKING A DEFINING BREAKTHROUGH STORY OF OUR TIME

INDIA'S EQUATION

If BYD's global credentials are so formidable, why has India remained relatively indifferent? The answer lies in the unique character of our home market. Cars here are rarely bought on engineering merit alone. Brand familiarity, trust, resale value, dealer reach, after-sales support and ownership experience matter just as much as performance or technology.

Then there is the geopolitical dimension. Chinese manufacturers carry baggage that extends beyond autos. They face policy scrutiny and funding restrictions, so much so that even superlative engineering alone cannot overcome it alone. Tesla's India showing itself proves that global

recognition does not always translate into sales success. Brand equity may generate headlines, but demand depends on pricing, localisation, customer confidence and a product strategy aligned with local realities.

For BYD, therefore, the challenge is not merely selling electric vehicles. It is earning trust.

BEYOND HEADLINES

Whether BYD will become a force in India is impossible to predict. Local manufacturing, policy stability, retail expansion, customer experience and long-term pricing will influence that outcome. But that is not the interesting question. The compelling one is whether India's auto conversation is paying sufficient attention to the profound shifts underway in the global industry.

Electric mobility is redrawing the hierarchy of automobile manufacturing. Companies that invested early in batteries, software and integrated manufacturing are challenging names that dominated the industry for decades. Yesterday's disruptors have become today's establishment, while a new generation of challengers is quietly reshaping the future.

India, quite rightly, will continue to evaluate every global manufacturer through the prism of its own economic interests, regulatory priorities and consumer expectations. And it should. But history teaches another lesson. Markets that cling too tightly to familiar reputations often recognise the next industrial revolution only after it has arrived and settled its roots.

Soliloquy: The auto sector has often proved this. Japanese firms changed the rules. The Koreans changed the pecking order. Whether BYD follows the same trajectory remains to be seen. What is beyond dispute is that one of the world's most forward auto firms remains largely absent from India's auto chatter. Perhaps that says something about BYD's challenge. Or perhaps it says something about India's tendency to recognise history only after it has become impossible to ignore.



WELLNESS

INSIDE AI CHANGED MINDS



As AI becomes an everyday companion, it is reshaping not only the way we work but also how we think, feel and relate to others

AUTHOR

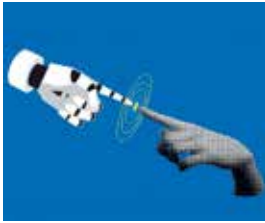


ERA DUTTA

essential part of healing: being understood by another human being. » **AI Validation** Seeking follows naturally. Instead of trusting their own judgement, people repeatedly ask AI whether they were right, attractive, successful, or justified. Psychologically, this resembles the reassurance-seeking commonly seen in anxiety disorders.

» **Digital Transference**, a concept borrowed from psychotherapy, describes attributing wisdom, authority, or emotional understanding to AI beyond what it actually possesses. Statements like, "ChatGPT understands me better than my family," often tell us less about AI and more about loneliness and unmet emotional needs.

» **Algorithmic Anxiety** affects many content creators. Every post, video, or reel is judged by an invisible algorithm. When visibility, opportunities, and income depend on a system no one fully understands, uncertainty becomes a chronic source of stress.



PERHAPS the healthiest relationship with AI is to treat it like a trusted co-pilot, not the pilot

» **AI Identity Diffusion** is quietly emerging among writers, designers, and students. If AI helped generate the idea, edited the draft, and improved the final product, whose work is it? Collaboration with AI expands creativity, but it also challenges our sense of authorship and originality.

TECHNOLOGY IS EXPOSING, NOT CREATING, HUMAN NEEDS

None of these experiences are officially recognised psychiatric diagnoses. They are observations of how rapidly evolving technology is reshaping human behaviour. The emotions themselves, however, are not new.

The need to feel capable. The need to belong. The need for certainty, confidence, and connection have existed long before AI arrived. Artificial intelligence did not create these psychological needs. It simply exposed them in new ways.

Perhaps the healthiest relationship with AI is to treat it like a trusted co-pilot, not the pilot. Let it challenge your thinking, not replace it. Let it sharpen your ideas, not generate every one of them.

Technology should make us more capable humans, not less confident ones.

Five years ago, none of these terms existed in a psychiatrist's vocabulary. Today, they are quietly appearing in consulting rooms, workplace conversations, and late-night chats with friends.

We've spent enormous energy asking what AI can do. We've spent far less asking what AI is doing to us. As artificial intelligence becomes woven into our daily lives, it isn't just changing how we work. It's changing how we think, relate, and even feel.

NEW PSYCHOLOGICAL EXPERIENCES IN THE AGE OF AI

Here are some of the new psychological experiences emerging in the age of AI:

- » **AI Dependency** is the growing tendency to rely on AI for thinking, decision-making, writing, or even regulating emotions. The telltale phrase is, "I can't write an email without asking ChatGPT." Used occasionally, AI is a useful assistant. Used constantly, it can quietly erode confidence in our own abilities.
- » **Cognitive Offloading** is closely related, where we outsource mental effort to technology instead of doing the thinking ourselves. We once did this with calculators and Google. AI takes it much further by writing, summarising, and solving problems for us. While convenient, excessive offloading may gradually weaken memory, creativity, and critical thinking.
- » **AI Burnout** is not exhaustion from AI itself, but from the relentless pressure to use it perfectly. Crafting the ideal prompt, optimising every workflow, and feeling guilty for not using AI efficiently enough has created a strange paradox: a productivity tool making people feel less productive.
- » **Prompt Paralysis** is another increasingly common phenomenon. Much like analysis paralysis, people spend so much time crafting the "perfect prompt" that they delay doing the actual work. The perfectionism simply shifts from the task to the instructions given to AI.
- » **Emotional Offloading** refers to venting thoughts and feelings to an AI chatbot instead of another person. This can be helpful as a form of journaling or self-reflection. But when AI becomes the only place where emotions are processed, we lose an

Beyond the Hindi Heartland

Through history, caste, religion and politics, Ghazala Wahab examines how the Hindi Heartland came to shape modern India's trajectory

AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA

First things first. *The Hindi Heartland* is an excellent book, and while we may draw our own interpretations from the minefield of data which Ghazala Wahab (a true Hindi heartlander from Agra and Delhi) brings to the table, the uncomfortable questions she raises—about caste, religion, Hindutva, reservations and growing polarisation—must engage every Indian, especially non-Hindi heartlanders (like me). For what, if I may ask, gives Hindi-speaking states the prerogative to assume that they constitute the heart of the nation in the anthropomorphic sense of the term? India's national anthem begins with Punjab, Sindh, Gujarat, Maratha, Dravida, Utkal and Banga, before Vindhya, Himachal, and the Yamuna and Ganga.

The book's geographical expanse of the Heartland stretches from Rajasthan to Jharkhand, with Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh in between. To my mind, Himachal could have been included as well, since it was carved out of Punjab on the basis of its lingua franca being Hindi amongst highlanders. Thirteen out of 16 Mahajanapadas in the kingdom of Emperor Ashoka were from the Hindi



an adequate inquiry into the circumstances which provoked the protesters into storming the police station.

Finally, Wahab covers one of the most contentious debates of Independent India—the demolition of the Babri Masjid in 1992. A Constitution had been formally adopted by the Indian government, but its tenets had not become commonplace within the still-new country's administration. The genesis of the Babri Masjid contention lay in the complicity of the then DM of Faizabad (as Ayodhya was called) in installing a statue of Ram Lalla in the mandir, and the failure of Prime Minister Nehru to get his own CM to act against the responsible duty-holders. Indira Gandhi and Rajiv Gandhi also appeased the RSS on the issue of the Babri Masjid, and this makes it clear that while the rhetoric and grand narratives of the Congress may have been different, political parties calibrate their public statements to complement the public mood.

In Wahab's view, the Hindi Heartland sets the template for India. My prognosis is different. India is changing, and the change is faster than what political leadership across parties can understand.

Defining characteristics today are unprecedented urbanisation and migration on account of an all-India labour market, along with greater enrolment of women in institutions of higher education and the feminisation of the workforce across sectors. The two major protests of this decade—the farmers' agitation in 2020 and the 2026 Gen Z movement against exam discrepancies—were driven by neither caste nor religion, but instead by issues of perceived loss around assured income and potential livelihoods. The next census will confirm that India no longer lives in villages. In the delimitation that will follow, the number of India's legislators and parliamentarians will register a four-fold increase—from 8% at present to at least 35%—thereby changing our country's political dynamics forever. The New India will be defined by the New Voter, and hopefully that is a fact to celebrate!

FROM THE MAHAJANAPADAS AND MUGHAL CAPITALS TO COLONIAL administration, THE REGION REPEATEDLY OCCUPIED THE CENTRE OF POLITICAL POWER

Heartland; a few centuries prior, in the Kurukshetra war of the Mahabharat, the bulk of the 18 Akshauhini military formations between the Kauravas and the Pandavas also came from the Kuru kingdom (spanning modern Haryana, Delhi and western Uttar Pradesh around Hastinapura and Indraprastha), the neighbouring Panchala kingdom (central/western UP), as well as Matsya (Rajasthan/Jaipur region), Surasena (Mathura region), Chedi (Bundelkhand region), Vatsa (Prayagraj/Kaushambi region), Anga and Magadh (Bihar).

While Magadh continued to be an important epicentre right up to the time of the Mauryan Empire, the Surasena Janapada in the Delhi-Mathura-Agra belt also punched well above its weight. Akbar's kingdom had sixteen *subahs*, and its two most important cities, Agra and Delhi, were part of the Heartland. The Mughals expanded agriculture, manufacturing and commerce by providing a pan-India market as well as a stable regime for

trade beyond the borders. Wahab believes that if Aurangzeb had not moved out of the HH to extend the regime to the Deccan, the Mughal Empire would not have ended the way it did. Be that as it may, the decline of the Mughals saw the rise of the East India Company, which used Indian money and Indian troops to achieve its decisive victory at Plassey. The *de jure* power of India was vested with the Mughal Emperor at the Red Fort in Delhi till the defeat and exile of Bahadur Shah Zafar to Burma in 1857. Even as the EIC made Calcutta the capital city, the Queen's Proclamation of 1858 was made at Allahabad in the Heartland, and over the next six decades, Delhi would again be resurrected as the capital of India.

Wahab argues that the rule of the EIC was more rapacious than anything that India had seen before. Other rulers—except for invaders—had a vested interest in ensuring that prosperity was a leitmotif both for urban settlements (the Ganj) and rural habitations (the Kasba), since the bulk of revenue came from agriculture. Benefactors lived, worked and spent their resources

within the subcontinent, and despite glaring inequality, there were no known cases of starvation deaths or serial famines because public works were put into motion at the hint of any such occurrences. But the shareholders of the EIC had no fidelity to Indian soil, and every decision aimed to extract as much profit as could be squeezed. The British diverted agricultural land from traditional peasant-economy staples like paddy, millets and wheat, forcing farmers to grow cash crops like indigo, opium, jute and sugarcane—besides diverting thousands of hectares for tea and coffee plantations—which led to a series of famines. Their narrative of India as a jewel in the dazzling British Empire was a successful one; it took Dadabhai Naoroji and RC Dutt to document the drain of the Indian economy and the ruthless exploitation of the peasantry for it to crack. Slavery had officially been abolished, but indentured labour had not; hundreds of thousands of Indians were uprooted from their land for generations. The British were then successful in building myths around "martial" and "non-martial" races while recruiting

soldiers for their army from regions which had been loyal to them in 1857. They had realised that the best way to govern was by dividing India's communities on everything from language to participation in education.

Caste is more salient than religion, Wahab avers, as is also narrated through Ambedkar's lived experience in Waiting for a Visa. She delves into the growing marginalisation of tribes who have been shelved as a category under the Fifth and Sixth Schedules. Even as Birsa Munda is appropriated by both the Left and the Right, his tribal kinsmen are systematically deprived of their rights in the forest. But religion was the fault line which the British government systematically exploited towards Partition in India. Her take on the freedom struggle delves into a counter-narrative on Chauri Chaura—while Gandhi and the Congress mobilised funds for the 22 policemen who had died, she questions whether there was



Early heat waves, the prospect of an intense El Niño and fertiliser supply disruptions from the West Asia conflict could converge into a formidable challenge for Indian agriculture

Heat, War and Harvests

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

Temperatures at 3-4°C above normal in March have become common over the last five years. This has had an adverse impact on production and productivity in agriculture and horticulture across North India. The fruit belts of Kashmir, Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh (mostly apples, cherries, plums and apricots), Uttar Pradesh (mangoes), and the agricultural belt stretching from Punjab and Haryana to Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and West Bengal are all impacted. This is likely to be compounded by the scarcity of fertilisers due to the war in West Asia, as well as the Super El Niño expected in 2026, which will contribute to the heat wave through ocean currents originating in the Pacific Ocean. Let us discuss these issues in more detail here.

IMPACT ON HORTICULTURE AND AGRICULTURE

The early onset of heat waves has been witnessed over the last five years or so. This has had an adverse impact on apple, cherry and pear growers in Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh, as well as apricot and plum growers in Kumaon in Uttarakhand. In particular, the lack of snowfall in Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh this year led to the early budding of apples and a short 'chilling period', which is so important for apples. Moreover, the heat also leads to pests and diseases, affecting quality and productivity. Similarly, the mango crop, which is in the flowering stage at the moment, is vulnerable to erratic weather patterns, with unusually hot days alternating with storms and unseasonal rain. It is estimated that India may lose 20% of its annual mango production this year.

The early onset of heat waves also impacts the standing rabi crop of wheat and maize, as well as disrupting planning for the kharif season. For example, heat stress as well as temperature fluctuations in February and March 2026 have led to wheat kernels turning violet or purple in North India. Since 2022, it has been observed that early heat waves have led to a loss of 15-20% of the rabi wheat crop in North India. However, the 2025 rabi crops, being harvested now (mainly wheat, maize, mustard and chana), escaped the adverse impact of a hot March because of the bountiful monsoons earlier. Only crops such as jeera and isabgol were impacted.

THE WEST ASIA WAR AND FERTILISER SUPPLY

However, the war in West Asia is likely to impact the coming kharif planting. Even though the stocks of urea and DAP are sufficient, they won't suffice. India imports urea and DAP from GCC countries, and this supply has been hit. Further, other inputs used to manufacture fertilisers, such as sulphur (used to manufacture sulphuric acid, which, in turn, is used to make phosphoric acid and superphosphates), ammonia (used to manufacture urea, ammonium nitrate and ammonium sulphate), and liquefied natural gas (an energy source used to make nitrogen-based fertilisers such as urea), are also sourced from the Middle East. As a result of the disruption in the supply of fertilisers and their inputs, fertiliser prices may come under strain.

Even pesticide supplies may be affected. More specifically, the supply of naphtha has been cut back. Naphtha is used to produce ethylene, butadiene and propylene, as well as benzene, toluene and xylene, which, in turn, are used to manufacture insecticides and herbicides.

SUPER EL NIÑO EFFECT

It is expected that the El Niño effect in 2026 will be more intense than in

3-4°C RISE ABOVE NORMAL TEMPERATURES CITED FOR MARCH

15-20% ESTIMATED WHEAT CROP LOSSES LINKED TO EARLY HEAT WAVES SINCE 2022

20% POTENTIAL LOSS IN INDIA'S ANNUAL MANGO PRODUCTION CITED FOR THIS YEAR

24 MILLION TONNES WHEAT STOCKS CITED WITH THE FCI AND STATES

36 million tonnes MILLED RICE STOCKS CITED WITH THE FCI AND STATES



other years. Climatologists estimate that the 'Super' El Niño will result from a breakdown of the unusually long period of La Niña and the rapid warming of the Pacific Ocean. This will translate into prolonged heat waves in India and may also result in the disruption of the monsoons, which will have an impact on agriculture and water resources.

CONCLUSION

The advancement of heat waves to March, the Super El Niño effect, and the disruption of fertiliser, input and pesticide supplies because of the war in West Asia will make this a testing time for Indian agriculture. Indeed, it will impact the supply of fertilisers on all continents of the world, including North America. For India, there is a need to plan for alternative sources as well as shift to domestic production of fertilisers. For now, the bumper rabi crop and the comfortable food stocks with the Food Corporation of India and the states (24 million tonnes of wheat and 36 million tonnes of milled rice) will see India through the crisis.





(Team) India's Fitness Dogma

A worrying injury list has exposed cracks in Indian cricket's fitness management, raising questions over workload, rehabilitation and the BCCI's approach to keeping players match-ready

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

by any stretch of the imagination, has preserved himself so well. Then came the doubts over Hitman. People said he was like the famous Mumbai street dish 'vada pav' due to weight gain. The remarkable transformation of Rohit Sharma in the last one year has to be seen to be believed, dropping over 10 kilos, getting stronger and ready to bat like a devil. Caught in negativity and digging in his heels, he refused to call it a day on his ODI career. And the man who wanted to see the back of Rohit Sharma is Ajit Agarkar, chairman of the selection committee, who is arrogant and thinks he is too big.

It is well known that when Rohit Sharma came out smoking with that knock of 138 runs in 110 balls at Lord's, he shut up his critics, and Agarkar. That one innings showed Rohit is fit and ready to push harder. To imagine he will not be part of the ICC ODI World Cup in 2027 in South Africa is impossible, and this has been made clear by the BCCI secretary, Devjit Saikia.

The way the media has been baiting Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma is not even funny. For those who run agendas and campaigns on social media as well, the two former India captains are still full of swagger, style and substance. Well past their mid-30s, inching towards the 40 mark, the duo has defined what fitness is and how to preserve form.

Frankly speaking, fitness is the most misunderstood word in life. The common man is told he should avoid alcohol, tobacco and junk food. Yes, all this is bad for health and lifestyle diseases are creeping in, even as India battles hypertension and diabetes. Indian cricketers are perceived as Alpha Males; they are super fit, or so we are made to believe. Mega bucks as sponsorship deals, tattoos which make them look macho. Great, but where is the fitness level?

The list of injured is woefully long and wrong. Hardik Pandya, Jasprit Bumrah, Harshit Rana, Washington Sundar, Nitish Reddy — the list is long. What's the problem



THE RECOVERY CLOCK

An injury does not end when the pain disappears. Elite athletes generally move through several stages before being considered ready for competition — medical recovery, restoration of movement, rebuilding strength, sport-specific conditioning and finally exposure to match-level intensity. The crucial phase is often the transition between rehabilitation and competition. For cricketers, that transition can be particularly demanding. A fast bowler must progressively rebuild bowling volume and intensity; a batter needs repeated high-speed movements, running between wickets and long periods at the crease; while fielders must regain confidence in sprinting, diving, throwing and changing direction. This is why medical clearance and match readiness are not necessarily the same thing. Returning too quickly can expose an athlete to compensatory movement, where other muscles or joints take additional strain. Modern sports science therefore increasingly focuses not merely on a "return to play", but on a "return to performance" — the point at which an athlete can safely reproduce the demands of competition over a sustained period.

with these guys, old and young? It is a fact that Bumrah is still the star strike bowler. He has flirted with fitness problems for long, so to expect him to be around forever is wrong. As a speedster with an action where the front-foot loading is pronounced, his back-injury flare-ups will be regular. The latest is that Bumrah has a knee issue. The human musculoskeletal body cannot be viewed in isolation. Each part, each area, each muscle, tendon and ligament — all are linked. One injury means another injury can happen. That is, unless the rehab and strength and conditioning have been top class.

Why the Indian cricketers are falling to injuries cannot be understood! The problem is that folks confuse cardio capacity tests with fitness. Earlier, the Yo-Yo scale was used as a gold-standard test. Now comes the Bronco Test. If players were failing the Bronco Test, they could not have been part of the IPL. The Bronco Test alone will not be defining; it measures peak cardio capacity. There has to be an individual assessment of each player after a cricket series. The fitness standard of a Harshit Rana or Nitish Reddy has to be higher than Bumrah's. Sadly, youngsters are not spending time on their bodies.

Is seeking help at the Bengaluru fitness centre run by the BCCI the sole solution? No, players have enough money to own a private gym at home, hire trainers and focus on their good health. Dear Indian cricketers, one does not need to show off ripping muscles. The real strength is not in bulk and bulge; it is in being super fit and shouldering the load as a national duty.

People at home, as cricket fans, are ignorant; fitness and performance are interlinked. Unless the body is free from injury, in good shape and ready to shoulder the load, performance will be below par. A batter may still get away with a niggle, but not bowlers and each man who has to field. Perhaps, the fielding downfall has been pronounced, which saw India flounder in the recent white-ball series in Ireland and England.

Up next, India are in Sri Lanka, ready for Test cricket. Under coach Gautam Gambhir, performance in red-ball cricket has crashed like indices in a stock market caught in a bear run. One needs quality bowlers to win matches. That is not to be seen. Test-quality bowlers are absent and there is not one boy or man who can replace match-winner Jasprit Bumrah. Sri Lanka has been an unhappy hunting ground. Even their spinners can trip India, with the Test series looming.

It is not as if I am trying to present a bleak picture. The reality is that five months after India won the ICC T20 World Cup, so much has changed. Performances have hit the nadir in T20s and ODIs. Gambhir is answerable, even as we hear arrogant Agarkar will be jettisoned. The BCCI needs professionals who can address a major problem: dealing with injuries.

Selection is based on form alone in India. The time has come when each player's fitness has to be measured and monitored daily. If there is a problem, identify it. If there is some issue, send him to rehab. Rushing players back into play will do no good; see how Harshit Rana is collapsing every second day. A coach or chairman of the selection committee is incapable of understanding fitness woes.

The time has come when the BCCI needs a full-time department which will assess player fitness holistically. At present, the Team India players are like patients taking discharge against medical advice and landing in more trouble. There is no way fitness can be compromised or overlooked. Jasprit Bumrah is on borrowed time; use him only in spells and plan his series. He cannot be played every day. Bumrah will, eventually, have to choose which format he will stick to, as the body refuses to shoulder the hard load. And I say this with respect for what BOOM has done for India. He is still a match-winner but needs to be nursed.

Lifestyle

FIVE HABITS TO MAINTAIN DURING THE RAINY SEASON

MONSOON BRINGS WELCOME RELIEF FROM THE HEAT, BUT IT CAN ALSO DISRUPT REGULAR FITNESS ROUTINES. FREQUENT SHOWERS, SLIPPERY ROADS, INCREASED HUMIDITY, AND A HIGHER RISK OF SEASONAL INFECTIONS OFTEN MAKE IT CHALLENGING TO STAY ACTIVE. WITH A FEW SIMPLE ADJUSTMENTS, YOU CAN STAY FIT AND HEALTHY THROUGHOUT THE SEASON.



RESORT TO INDOOR WORKOUTS

Rainy weather may not always permit outdoor activities like jogging or cycling. On such a day, one can opt for indoor exercises such as yoga, strength training, Pilates, skipping, or home workout routines. These activities help maintain fitness levels while eliminating the risk of slipping or getting drenched in the rain.

PRIORITISE IMMUNITY THROUGH NUTRITION



A balanced diet plays a crucial role in supporting overall health during the monsoon. Include seasonal fruits, vegetables, whole grains, lean proteins, and foods rich in vitamins C and D. Stay hydrated even if you feel less thirsty, and limit the intake of fried or street foods.



SWITCH TO THE RIGHT FITNESS GEAR

Humidity and damp conditions can lead to discomfort and skin infections. Choose lightweight, moisture-wicking workout clothes and well-cushioned, non-slip footwear for better grip and comfort. Always dry your shoes and clothing thoroughly after exercising to prevent fungal growth.



MAINTAIN CONSISTENCY WHILE EXERCISING

Consistency is more important than intensity during the rainy season. Aim for at least 30 minutes of moderate physical activity most days of the week. If exercising outdoors, avoid waterlogged areas, slippery surfaces, and thunderstorms.

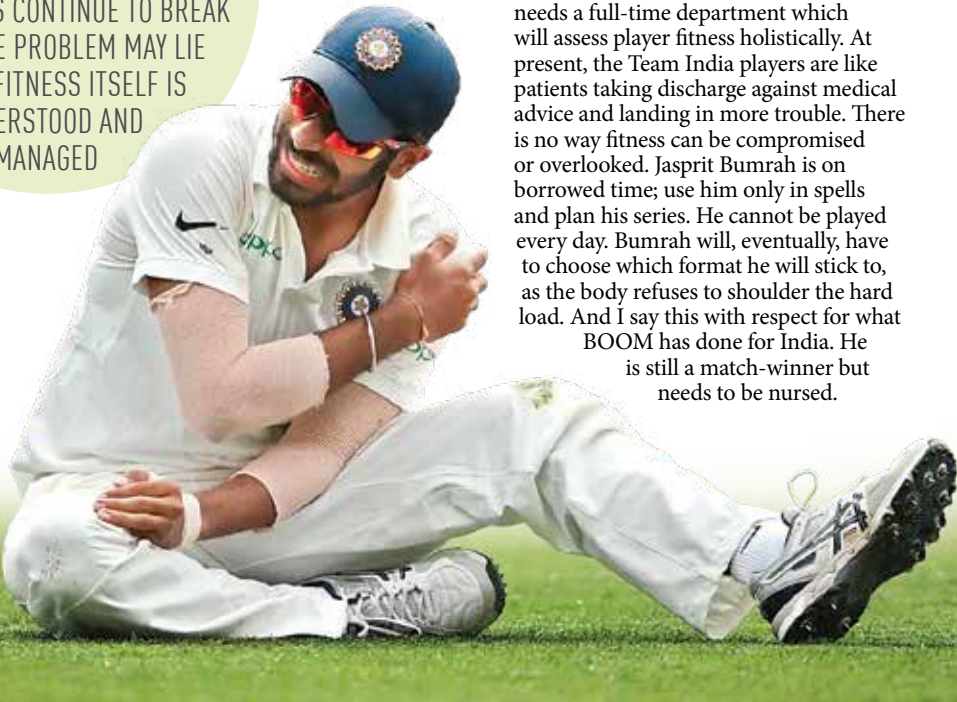


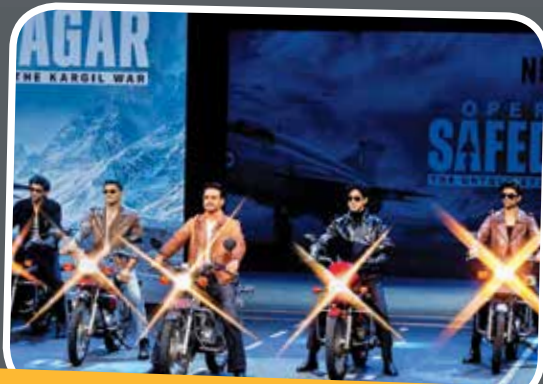
ALWAYS FOCUS ON RECOVERY AND HYGIENE

The humid weather can increase fatigue and the likelihood of infections. Ensure adequate sleep, stretch before and after workouts, and maintain good personal hygiene. Shower promptly after exercising, keep your workout gear clean, and wash your hands regularly to minimise exposure to germs.



INDIAN CRICKET HAS MONEY, FACILITIES, TRAINERS AND CUTTING-EDGE fitness tests, YET PLAYERS CONTINUE TO BREAK DOWN. THE PROBLEM MAY LIE IN HOW FITNESS ITSELF IS UNDERSTOOD AND MANAGED





OPERATION SAFED SAGAR

A STORY OF PEOPLE BEHIND THE UNIFORMS

Siddharth and Jimmy Shergill believe authenticity was the guiding principle on the show inspired by the Indian Air Force's role in the 1999 Kargil War

Patriotism in Netflix's new series 'Operation Safed Sagar' comes not from larger-than-life heroics but from portraying the people behind the uniforms with honesty, said actors Siddharth and Jimmy Shergill, who believe authenticity was the guiding principle on the show inspired by the Indian Air Force's role in the 1999 Kargil War.

The series chronicles 'Operation Safed Sagar', the Indian Air Force's campaign during the Kargil conflict and follows the Golden Arrows Squadron as it undertakes high-altitude combat missions while also exploring the personal lives of the officers and their families.

Siddharth, who essays Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja, said he was initially reluctant to take on the project because it was based on real events and real people.

"I was hesitant for two reasons because it's a real person and it's not just me who's going to do the tribute of this character. It's a whole team of people. So, I didn't know what their intentions were because it's very easy for someone to take a subject like this and do it in a very easy commercial way to get applause. Their intent was so pure and their research was so tight that I was very clear from the get-go that this is going to be, as beautifully you put it, human drama, set against the Air Force, set against the time of the target war. That's the best way to describe this experience," the actor told PTI in an interview.

He said what impressed him most was the effort to understand the individuals behind the military ranks. "Before they are pilots, they're human beings first and to understand those human beings, the effort that was made was amazing. I give credit to Kushal Srivastav, who's an ex-air force man, who is the starting point of this creation. I think that lent this very unique air to this project."

The 'Rang De Basanti' star said receiving the support of the Indian Air Force and the families of those depicted in the series convinced him to come on board. "The most important thing that tilted it, where it was a project that I can't afford to miss, was one, the blessing of the air force and the permission and the blessing of the families involved. So, those two things really helped."



Shergill, who plays Wing Commander B S Dhanoa, said the makers were encouraged to stay as close to reality as possible while telling the story. "It all depends on the makers what kind of a concept they have and how they want to make that. Here with this show, the Air Force has given a brief to these people, to try and keep it as real and close to real life as possible," said the actor, known for movies such as 'Haasil', 'Maqbool', 'Yahaan', 'A Wednesday!' and 'Saheb, Biwi Aur Gangster'.

At the same time, the actor believes there was room in cinema for different interpretations of patriotism. "I don't see anything wrong if a director wants to

make a film, which is high octane and everything like that; it is cinema. As long as it is made correctly, then people like it. Everybody has a right to make it their own way. As long as it's good, it's going to work. Don't force your views on somebody else. Just because you don't like that kind of stuff doesn't mean it's bad," he said.

Siddharth said everyone involved in the project was conscious of the responsibility that came with portraying one of the Indian Air Force's defining operations. "We've come into this team with an intent that the air force, we have to do the air force proud. Now, that's the kind of pressure that is very good because it prevents you from doing stupid things.

But while we were doing it, we were completely aware of

our responsibility; we understood the assignment."

Created by Abhijeet Singh Parmar and Kushal Srivastava and directed by Oni Sen, 'Operation Safed Sagar' also stars Abhay Verma, Mihir Ahuja, Taa-ruk Raina, Arnav Bhasin, Dia Mirza, Prajakta Koli, Adil Hussain and Amrita Bagchi.

For both Ahuja and Bhasin, landing the opportunity to portray war heroes early in their career was a significant milestone.

Ahuja said casting director Deepak Agarwal reached out to him for the role of flying officer C H Bal Reddy and he auditioned wearing the coveralls provided by the team.

"When the project came to me, I was like, 'Oh my God, like, I'm getting to play an Air Force pilot.' So, while reading the script, I was sitting upright; I had to show respect to that script and character," the actor, who garnered acclaim for his work in 'Made in

Heaven', 'The Archies' and 'Vijay 69', said.

Ahuja said he was among the last actors to be cast in the project. Finalised just days before filming began, he found himself reporting to the Bikaner Air Force Station for the shoot. "I was just awestruck, like everyone seeing the MiG-21 aircraft around them; I get goosebumps if I'm talking about it. But it was a great ride to be a part of this project; it's been one of my best experiences so far."

Bhasin said he felt 'honoured and privileged' to be part of the series. "I feel everybody would feel the same as this is in collaboration with the Indian Air Force and that is a very big deal," the actor, best known for his work on OTT shows like 'Cubicles' and 'The Insiders', said.

He added that he was fully charged to commit to the show in any capacity. "It looks really cool when I'm walking out in slow motion at 60 FPS (Frames Per Second), wearing aviators, with eight guys standing right behind me. To be a part of something like that, even if the makers would have made me do anything, I would do it and it makes you believe you did it all on your own," Bhasin added.

PTI

THE SERIES
FOLLOWS THE GOLDEN
ARROWS SQUADRON AS IT
UNDERTAKES HIGH-ALTITUDE
COMBAT MISSIONS WHILE ALSO
EXPLORING THE PERSONAL
LIVES OF THE OFFICERS
AND THEIR FAMILIES



SENSE AND SENSIBILITY

AUTHOR



BY SUPRIYA NEWAR



Two road incidents over the last fortnight, both entirely unplanned, left me thinking long after they were over. Both unfolded on our monsoon-battered roads - cratered, clogged and congested, with each offering a very different takeaway.

About 15 days ago, on a particularly wet evening, we were negotiating some bumper-to-bumper traffic while returning home. I was seated in the rear and my driver was at the wheel, making a right turn on a very busy roundabout, when one of those ubiquitous 10-minute delivery scooters zipped past us. He braked suddenly to avoid the scooter, as a result of which a bulky SUV speeding behind us rammed right into my car. It all happened, as these things do, within seconds, before any one of us could wrap our heads around what had happened.

Despite it pouring buckets, the driver of that beast of a vehicle got down. Though he and his vehicle were completely undamaged, he hurled a volley of abuse at my driver, who was unsuccessfully trying to show him the state of the right-hand rear gate, which looked more like crumpled scrap than a car. Perhaps



Two road incidents left me thinking long after they were over

noticing the damage, the driver sped off.

Since we were at a very busy crossing and it was raining hard, we had to pull over before we could find a corner to assess the damage. What I saw was pretty heartbreaking, more so because the car was barely a month old, purchased after nearly eight years, after many test drives, after some financial planning and saving and whatever it takes to buy a new vehicle.

And yet, despite both the right-hand gates being badly smashed, I was neither upset nor fuming. In fact, the first coherent thought I had was one of gratitude for the fact that I was not sitting on the right side and both my driver and I had come

out completely unscathed. Crushed metal, I thought, was better than a broken limb or a cracked bone! Yes, the car would have to go to the garage, insurance would have to be claimed and paperwork completed. But all of that paled beside the larger fact: we had walked away unhurt.

It was a moment that acted almost like a compass, quietly pointing me in a certain direction - perhaps one sign of growing up is being able to accept a loss or a mishap, immediately zoom out and start working on the solution instead of brooding over the incident. I could have been angry at that scooter, but then do I not avail 10-minute deliveries?

I could have stepped out and matched

the abuses of that burly SUV driver, showing him the damage, the speed and girth of his vehicle had caused, but it didn't make sense to do so. Instead, I chose not to fight that battle. My car got back from the garage after a fortnight or so, with both gates replaced, leaving little evidence of the accident beyond the memory of it. The driver took a day off to go and offer prayers at Kali mandir and though I only thanked God silently, I could appreciate his need to do so.

I mentioned two road incidents. This was the first. The second one was



CRUSHED METAL,
I THOUGHT, WAS
BETTER THAN A BROKEN
LIMB OR A CRACKED
BONE!

more humbling. The other day, as torrential rains hit our city, the streets were completely waterlogged as usual by the evening. Once again, as I was returning home, I couldn't help but feel exasperated at the chaos all around me; bumper-to-bumper traffic that didn't even seem to move at a snail's pace; unrelenting honking all around and the hang-over having been recently hit. All of it brought more than a crease to my forehead, until I saw two children, having a whale of a time in those very flooded streets, splashing each other with water, racing down, dancing - neither of them seemed to have a single care in the world or to be bothered about the chaos all around them, the dirty water that had gathered, the drains that were blocked, the traffic that was nothing other than a serpentine of red taillights.

Watching them was a lesson in living in the present, delivered far better than it is by life coaches and gurus on 'YouTube' videos or 'WhatsApp' forwards. My eyes stayed on them for as long as I could see them, their exuberance refreshing and innocent. Once again, I was reminded of how growing up teaches us to look for an umbrella or keep it handy even as the skies turn grey, rather than darning to revel or splash around in it. Supriya Newar is a multilingual writer and poet from Calcutta. Besides being a music aficionado, she is also an avid traveller. She may be reached at connect@supriyanewar.com